C R O W E

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FADE IN:

EXT. ORPHANAGE — FENCED PERIMETER - NIGHT

SUPER: WILLOW'S CREEK, WYOMING

Thunder rumbles. Lightning exposes a chain link fence. *NO TRESPASSING* signs barely hang on.

A grimy, rusted sign: *WILLOW'S CREEK ORPHANAGE*— choked in ivy. Sways in the breeze.

ROXY (25), wearing impractical athleisure, stumbles up the road. Blood streaking her face. She gasps. Glancing back—

A HOODED FIGURE follows. Calm. Phone raised— streaming.

SNARED LIVE pulses on screen. View c00000000000ount spikes: *3500… 4000…*

Thumbs-up emojis. Scrolling comments:

— *@StreamFreak99: RUN, BITCH RUN!!!*
— *@HaterN8ion: FAKE AF. HER ACTING SUCKS.*
— *@SlasherStan: WHY IS HE WALKING? CHASE HER!!!*

Roxy hits the gate. Breathless. She claws at the padlocked chain. Squeezing through a gap. Desperate.

The hooded figure grabs her. Slams her against the fence. She sobs. Trembling. Eyes squeezed shut.

Roxy
Please… don't do this…

DA-DING! A notification slices the tension.

— *SNARE COMPLETE: FEAR FACTOR — 5K VIEWS*

Roxy cracks one eye, sees the phone— grins.

ROXY (CONT'D)
Nailed it.

The hood comes off— WES (25), charming, cocky, athletic.

WES
Told you, babe.

They kiss. Victorious. A duffle bag hits the ground. LAZARIA (25), bold and blunt, folds her arms.

LAZARIA
You were supposed to *chase* her, Wes?

Roxy's already digging in the bag for makeup wipes.

WES
Name one killer that runs.

Roxy scrubs at the fake blood.

ROXY
Ah, Ghostface!?

Wes cracks a beer from the duffle.

WES
Please. Ghostface is a fucking pussy. Dumbass trips over his own robe.

LAZARIA
Whatever. The point is, running is terrifying. There's no escape.

WES
I disagree. Walking builds tension. Today's audience is evolved. You gotta give 'em more than a basic—

MARCUS (O.S.)
—JUMP SCARE?!

MARCUS (25), a chiseled stoner nerd, grabs Wes from behind. Wes yelps— beer flies. The girls smirk

MARCUS (CONT'D)
Man's got a point, though.

Marcus sparks a joint.

MARCUS (CONT'D)
Running jacks your heart rate. Spikes your adrenaline— triggers your sympathetic nervous system.
(beat)
Vasoconstriction kicks in, blood redirects. Your brain freaks out— pre-frontal cortex and amygdala go all primal, and your motor skills disappear quicker than a virgin on prom night.

The group bursts into laughter. Marcus takes a drag.

MARCUS (CONT'D)
It's facts, yo. Y'all need to get the fuck educated.

Wes pulls bolt cutters from the bag. He hands them to Marcus.

WES
(to Marcus)
You're up, my guy.

LAZARIA
You're breaking in here? Seriously?

Roxy switches to Marcus' phone and starts streaming.

MARCUS
Gotta go big, Ria. Three more snares and I'm Tier-4, baby.

Marcus struggles with the cutters.

ROXY
What makes this place so risky?

SNAP! The lock gives. The gate groans open. Viewer count climbs: *2300… 2500… 2700…*

MARCUS
This is where it all went down…

He grins. Steps into the paddock. The others follow.

INT. ORPHANAGE — ATTIC - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

A hulking figure looms behind a cracked window. Fog blooms on the glass from their breath.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — PADDOCK - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

Marcus surveys the overgrown lawn.

MARCUS
The Willow's Creek Massacre.

Blank stares.

MARCUS (CONT'D)
The Boogeyman of Willow's Creek?

Roxy laughs.

ROXY
The what?

LAZARIA
Probably some bullshit urban legend.

Marcus glares at her.

MARCUS
Fuck you, *urban legend*. This shit's true-crime. One hundred percent real.

Wes grins— story time.

WES
Oh shit, here it comes—

Lightning splits the sky as Marcus turns to the Orphanage.

MARCUS
Fifteen years ago… in this exact spot.
(MORE)

MARCUS (CONT'D)
(beat)
Shit got real fucked up.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — PADDOCK - DAY (FLASHBACK)

SUPER: 15 YEARS AGO

Sunlight. Fresh paint. Kids play across the lawn. Peaceful.

MARCUS (V.O.)
There was this caretaker— Christian Crowe. Big as fuck. Seven-foot, three-hundred pounds, easy.

CHRISTIAN CROWE (30), a silent, mammoth of a man. Splits logs with an axe.

WHACK! A rock smacks his head. He blinks. Swings again.

Three teenage punks— AIDEN, JAYDEN, and HAYDEN, (17) huddled together. Snickering. Taunting.

AIDEN
You retarded, Crowe?

JAYDEN
Or just fucking stupid?

HAYDEN
He looks like Jason and Freddy's test tube baby.

Another rock. Christian flinches. Silent.

Aiden readies a third when— A GIRL (13), confident, defiant strides in with, YOUNG ASTRID (10), quiet, observant.

GIRL
Oh look. The inbred trio. Aiden, Jayden and Hayden.

AIDEN
Keep walkin', bitch.

YOUNG ASTRID
Just leave him alone, he hasn't done anything to you.

Hayden steps forward, eyeing Astrid.

HAYDEN
(mocking)
Aw, baby's gotta protect her daddy?

The girl steps forward. Calm. Unflinching.

GIRL
You got two choices— walk away…

Hayden steps up.

HAYDEN
Or what?

GIRL
I'll make you regret staying.

A tense beat. Hayden hesitates— sizes her up. Then backs off.

HAYDEN
Whatever. Freakshow ain't worth it.

Jayden shoves Astrid as he passes. Christian moves— fast. Grabs Jayden. Axe raised

Jayden freezes. A wet patch spreads across his pants. He glances toward the others— already running.

JAYDEN
S-Sorry, Mr. Crowe. W—We were just messing around—

Astrid gently places a hand on Christian's arm. He breathes. The axe lowers. He releases Jayden.

Christian spots the Chief of Police, ALFIE (45), watching. He gives a subtle nod. Continues on his way.

GIRL
You good, Big Guy?

Christian resumes chopping. Astrid grips her friend's hand— matching *BFF* bracelets glint in the sun.

INT. ORPHANAGE — BEDROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

Astrid sits on her bed. She Strings a colorful bead bracelet. One word stands out: *DAD.* She smiles.

CREAK! She turns— Aiden, Jayden and Hayden. White masks on.

Astrid bolts. They grab her. Aiden clamps a hand over her mouth. Hayden presses a knife to her throat.

HAYDEN
Scream, and I'll fucking cut you.

She nods. Trembling. Terror glistening in her wide eyes.

Aiden moves his hand— Astrid screams. Primal. Piercing. She thrashes wildly. Hayden panics— loses his grip.

SLASH! The blade rips across her left cheek—

Blood trickles. The boys freeze. Rattled. Masks come off.

AIDEN
What the fuck?! You were just supposed to scare her.

HAYDEN
S-She moved! I-I didn't mean—

BANG! The door explodes open. Christian stands in the doorway— axe held firmly across his chest.

Aiden turns. Too late—

SHHHNK! The axe tears through his throat. His head snaps back. Gouts of blood spray the walls.

Hayden drops the knife. Sprints for the door. Christian swings again—

CRUNCH! The axe cleaves his stomach open. He crumples.

Jayden grabs the knife— trembling. He swings. Misses.

Christian grabs him by the throat, lifting him effortlessly.

JAYDEN
S-Sorry, Mr. Crowe. W—We were just messing around—

Astrid, staggers forward. Her small hand reaches out. Trembling. She touches Christian's arm— *a familiar scene.*

YOUNG ASTRID
Dad… stop! Please.

Christian freezes. Jayden takes his shot. Stabs Christian— deep through the face. One cheek, out the other. Lodging grotesquely in his mouth.

YOUNG ASTRID (CONT'D)
DAAAAD!

Christian howls, drops Jayden. Knocks Astrid aside. He rips the blade free— leaving a gaping hole.

Jayden lunges for the open door, but— the Girl steps in.

GIRL
Where the fuck you goin?

She shoves him back. Christian steps in.

THUNK! The axe buries into Jayden's skull. Blood spatters the Girl's face— *strangely she doesn't flinch— just smiles.*

Christian turns to Astrid. Their eyes lock— *a twisted father-daughter moment.*

He looks down. The masks. The now-bloodstained *"Dad"* bracelet.

He picks a mask up. Studies it— grotesque features distorted by blood staining on the eye sockets. Then— he puts it on.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

The group reach the heavy wooden door. Aged. Rotted.

MARCUS
Crazy motherfucker snapped. Hacked up almost everyone inside.

Lazaria cuts in, skeptical.

LAZARIA
If he was her dad, why the hell'd she live here?

MARCUS
Said he wasn't fit. But the Chief got him a caretaker gig— kept him close.

The door yawns open— alone. They freeze.

Marcus smirks. He heads in. The others follow, reluctantly.

INT. ORPHANAGE — FOYER - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Pitch black. Flashlights flick on— slicing through cobwebs.

Roxy smiles as the view count climbs: *4200… 4400… 5000…*

ROXY
Cool ghost story. Fans are loving it.

Lazaria rolls her eyes.

LAZARIA
We should've brought a Ouija board or some shit.

WES
Fuck Ouija's. That shit's played out.

Thunder crashes. Rain pounds the boarded windows.

LAZARIA
So if everyone got sliced and diced— how does your ass know so much?

Wes and Marcus exchange a look.

WES
He said *"almost"* everyone.

Marcus lifts his shirt. Deep burn scars streak his torso.

The girls recoil. Shocked.

BANG! A door slams somewhere inside.

Roxy swings her flashlight— landing on a rusted tricycle.

ROXY
Nope. Fuck this! I'm out. I am not dying for content.

She cuts the livestream. Marcus grabs her arm.

MARCUS
Relax, Rox. No one's dying, okay.

ROXY
That's a fucking tricycle, Marcus.
(beat)
Next thing, there's creepy-ass twins riding 'em down the hall.

LAZARIA
I'm with Rox. Y'all can keep that *"Redrum"* bullshit to yourself.

They turn, but— Wes blocks their path.

WES
Before you leave… you wanna know the real reason we're here?

Marcus steps forward, dramatic.

MARCUS
Christian Crowe…

Roxy freezes. Lazaria stiffens.

MARCUS (CONT'D)
Legend has it. If you look in a mirror— say his name five times—

LAZARIA
Fuck you… that's the Candyman, dipshit.

DA-DING!

— SNARE COMPLETE: SURVIVE A HAUNTED HOUSE — 7K VIEWS

ROXY
You assholes.

Wes and Marcus laugh. High five.

WES
How'd you really get the scars?

MARCUS
It was a fucking firecracker. When I was a kid.

*BUZZ! A n*ew notification. Wes reads it aloud.

WES
New Snare: *"Steal something from the Orphanage."*
(MORE)

WES (CONT'D)
(beat)
An easy 5000 views.

Marcus spots a decrepit rocking horse.

MARCUS
Boom. Rocking horse of doom.

LAZARIA
Hell no. As if that's not a fucking conduit for malevolent energy.

The boys laugh. Lazaria doesn't. Real fear creeping in.

LAZARIA (CONT'D)
Stupid-ass touching cursed junk… Fuckin' demons be poppin' out and shit. Fuck that. Let's go Rox.

Lazaria goes to leave. Roxy stops her.

ROXY
Wait… how'd they know we're here?

All eyes on Roxy.

ROXY (CONT'D)
It said, *"Steal something from the Orphanage."* How'd they know?

Marcus and Wes trade looks.

MARCUS
I don't know? Geo-tracking, maybe?

Roxy doesn't buy it. Her face drains.

ROXY
What happened to Crowe? His daughter?

MARCUS
I don't fucking know. Crowe story's all bullshit— it's an urban legend.

WES
That's how true-crime works. A grain of truth with some bullshit mystery and bam— instant credibility, baby.

Lazaria shines her light on the wall. Photos of them. Candid.

LAZARIA
Yo, what the fuck is this?

The group circles. Shocked.

ROXY
Who was the Architect?

WES
Some guy named— *"The Raven."*
(beat)
First Snare I've gotten from him, though.

MARCUS
No shit? Me too.

LAZARIA
Hundreds of Architects, and the same one sends you both Snares?

Wes eyes a polaroid— two girls with matching *BFF* bracelets.

WES
Who are they?

Roxy leans in. Eyes wide.

ROXY
Oh shit. That's—

BANG! The front door flies open— wind and rain whip through.

Wes runs to close it— he freezes.

CHRISTIAN CROWE (52) fills the doorway. Massive. Mud-caked boots. Blood-streaked mask.

He grips a brutal, custom axe— one end a spearpoint, the other, a gleaming double-bevel blade.

Wes trembles. Paralyzed—

SQUELCH! The axe-handle impales him through the chest.

Blood gushes. Wes slumps. Twitching. Dead.

Crowe steps inside.

INT. ALFIE'S CAR - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

A busted-up '47 Chevy rumbles down the rain-slick road.

ALFIE (73), ex-chief of police— haunted by years of guilt and regret— grips the wheel.

A distant scream pierces the night.

He slams the brakes. Eyes snap to the orphanage— then the busted gate.

He hesitates. Sighs. Shifts into gear. Drives on.

INT. ORPHANAGE — FOYER - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Marcus steps up. Crowe swings. Marcus ducks. Fires back— one, two, three. Fists land with precision. Crowe doesn't flinch.

WHACK! A swift backhand. Marcus crashes into the wall. His skull cracks. Blood drips. Crowe raises the axe.

THUNK! He splits Marcus' skull. Blood paints the walls.

SMASH! A last-ditch effort— Lazaria shatters a bottle over Crowe's head. Shards embed. He stumbles— but regains balance.

He pulls a shard from his flesh. Eyes lock onto Lazaria. Gripping the jagged bottleneck.

LAZARIA
Urban legend, my ass. Let's go, motherfucker!

She lunges— Crowe's faster. He snaps her wrist like a twig. Lazaria screams.

He takes the bottle from her limp hand. Flips it. Drives it into her face— twisting cruelly. She goes still.

He turns to Roxy. Looming over her. Axe raised. Breath raspy and inhuman behind the mask.

The axe swings down, and—

SMASH CUT TO:

Title Card: ***SNARED***

I/E. SNARED INTRO MONTAGE - VARIOUS

A live feed— Wes and Roxy's video paired with the guitar riffs of *"Killing in the Name" by* Rage Against the Machine.

NEWS ANCHOR-USA (V.O.)
…as authorities scramble, the viral app *Snared* spreads faster than they can contain it— pushing boundaries, and ethics, into chaos.

SWIPE! A barrage of global, adrenaline-pumped clips crash across the screen:

· *Teens laugh mid-class, phones hidden under desks.*

NEWS ANCHOR-AUS (V.O.)
…the algorithm scrapes your search history, locations, restaurants, shopping carts… even your DMs…

· *Bar crowd erupts over a dare-gone-wrong.*

NEWS ANCHOR-FRA (V.O.)
…once you take the personalized bait… you're snared. The only way out? Complete the snare and level up.

· *A nurse pauses at a patient's bed—*
— *SNARE: SWITCH SURGERY CHARTS — 20k VIEWS.*

NEWS ANCHOR-GBR (V.O.)
…but the government is now calling for a parliamentary inquiry following a surge in fatal incidents…

Interactive globe lights up. Red pins spread like contagion.

· *A MAN sits in a crowded airport:*
— *SNARE: YELL BOMB IN A CROWDED AIRPORT — 15k VIEWS.*

NEWS ANCHOR-ITA (V.O.)
…and as the death toll rises, experts warn *Snared* has has become less a game, and more a gateway drug.

· *A MAN opens a jar of baby food and spits inside:*
— *SNARE: CONTAMINATE FOOD IN a supermarket — 10k VIEWS.*

NEWS ANCHOR-CAN (V.O.)
…but calls to ban the app have gone unanswered as the app's developers claim they're *"not responsible for user behavior."*

· *A YOUNG WOMAN standing out the front of a Mosque:*
— *SNARE: DEFACE A PLACE OF WORSHIP — 12k VIEWS.*

NEWS ANCHOR-IND (V.O.)
…while some are calling it the future of entertainment, others say it's just legalized sadism.

· *A FIGURE in a hoodie slides from under a parked car:*
— *SNARE: CUT RANDOM BRAKE LINES — 25K VIEWS.*

NEWS ANCHOR-JPN (V.O.)
…now officials all over the globe are urging citizens to delete the app immediately— though usage continues to skyrocket.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. CAFE — PARKING LOT - DAY

The figure bolts from the car— nearly slamming into BLAIR (25), a natural beauty with a down-to-earth edge— balancing a tray of iced coffees.

BLAIR
Seriously?

No apology. Just a hi-five to his crew and he's gone.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
(under breath)
I fucking hate this app.

She heads toward her two friends— CALLI (27), bold and too cool for subtlety, and ZEE (27), gender-fluid, loud proud, and still rocking *"he/him"* pronouns— because he fucking can.

They lean against Zee's car, glued to their phones.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Am I like… invisible?

Zee gasps dramatically, looking around.

ZEE
What? Who said that?

CALLI
Wait— you heard it too? Creepy.

BLAIR
Oh, you guys are hilarious.

Calli grabs the tray. Pulls out a sleek bottle of vodka. Pours it into the coffee's.

CALLI
A little espresso martini to get the day started.

Blair hesitates, raising a skeptical eyebrow.

BLAIR
I don't need vodka at 10AM to vibe.

ZEE
Bitch, you don't need shoes to run either, but it fucking helps.

Blair rolls her eyes. Grabs her coffee. Calli raises her cup.

CALLI
To alcohol— cause of, and solution to— all life's little problems.

They clink. Sip. Slide into the car.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — FRONT GATE - DAY

The washed-out sky hangs over the drenched paddock.

Alfie leans against a police cruiser. He dumps whiskey into his coffee-filled thermos like it's creamer.

A shadow stretches across the mud.

ALFIE
The prodigal son returns.

FRANK VALENTINE (40), steps forward. Worn. Wired. Clutching a manila folder. He clocks Alfie's cup.

FRANK
Still mixing drinks, huh?

ALFIE
Still got that chip, huh?

Frank smirks— but Alfie all business.

FRANK
So you think he's back, huh?

ALFIE
I don't think he ever left.

Frank raises a skeptical eyebrow.

FRANK
Or— it's just more kids glorifying shit for views.

Alfie scoffs, a bitter laugh escaping.

ALFIE
You sound like her.

He nods toward the orphanage. CHIEF RHEA NAVARRO (41), steps out. Notebook in hand. Uniform sharp. Expression sharper.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
She thinks I've cracked. Says the guilt finally won.

Frank keeps focused up ahead.

FRANK
Has it?

Alfie takes a beat— his silence speaks volumes.

ALFIE
You ever think about that night?
(beat)
If we made the right decision?

FRANK
Try not to. I mean, who needs the truth when you've got closure, right?

ALFIE
Maybe closure's just the last lie we choose to believe.

A quiet beat. Frank doesn't respond.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
She won't be thrilled to see you.

Frank shrugs it off.

FRANK
She's a big girl. She'll get over it.

Alfie’s tone hardens. Edged with authority.

ALFIE
Watch it, Frank… Show her some respect. She earned that badge.

Frank just smirks. Alfie heads for his rust-speckled pickup.

FRANK
Where you goin'?

ALFIE
Some trust-fund brats rented the cabin this weekend.
(beat)
They’re *“making content.”* Whatever the hell that means.

That grabs Frank’s attention. He raises a brow.

FRANK
Content? Out here?

Alfie shrugs. He hops in the car.

ALFIE
Good luck with your little… reunion. Try not to piss her off too much.

Frank looks at Rhea, approaching.

FRANK
You’re seriously gonna leave me to do this alone?

ALFIE
You’re a big boy, I’m sure you can handle it.

He chuckles. The truck rolls down the dirt road.

RHEA
Oh, you’ve gotta be shitting me.

Frank grins— smug as hell. Gives her a deliberate once-over.

FRANK
New uniform looks good on you, Chief.

RHEA
What do you want, Frank?

Frank raises an eyebrow, mockingly.

FRANK
Wow. No foreplay? You’ve changed.

Her gaze flicks to Alfie’s retreating truck.

RHEA
Did he fucking call you?

FRANK
Look, he's worried. That's all.

Rhea scoffs, shaking her head.

RHEA
No, he's delusional. It's his annual fucking breakdown.

FRANK
And if it's not?

The air shifts. A landmine of old memories between them.

RHEA
I'm a one-woman department, Frank. I don't have the time or patience for your big-city bullshit.

He hands her the manila folder.

FRANK
Last night we pinged a couple live-streams from the Orphanage. Then Alfie calls—

She flips through it— frowning.

RHEA
You "*pinged*" them? Last I heard the FBI kicked your ass out?

Frank smirks. A nod with practiced nonchalance.

FRANK
They did. I freelance now.

Rhea scoffs. She hands the folder back.

RHEA
So now you're chasing random B&E's?

FRANK
Ah, we both know this wasn't random.

RHEA
You know how many dumbass teens I've arrested for breaking in here?

FRANK
Yeah. But how many go MIA after?

She tries to walk away. He blocks her.

FRANK (CONT'D)
They're mythologizing Crowe. Stirring up the wrong kind of memories. This town can't—

RHEA
Oh, save it. You don't give a shit about this town. That's why you left.

She fires the shot. It lands.

RHEA (CONT'D)
You're here for your fucking redemption tour.

Frank shrugs.

FRANK
Maybe… Or maybe I just don't want history repeating itself.

Rhea exhales. Jaw clenched. Biting back her response.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Look, I ain't here for a pissing contest. I'm just following the breadcrumbs. If he's back then—

RHEA
—then let me do my goddamn job.

A moment. Then, he holds out the folder again.

FRANK
Or… We could do it together.

Their eyes lock. Silence. A reluctant surrender.

INT. ZEE'S CAR - DAY

Highway sprawls. Music pumps. Zee drives. Calli lounges shotgun. Blair's in the back. Full-blown off-key singalong.

The song ends. They take a breath. Laughing. Blair turns to the window. Quiet. Smiling. Zee clocks her in the mirror.

ZEE
Real talk though, B? I'm glad your sexy ass came.

Blair shrugs, feigning indifference.

BLAIR
Binging '*The Boys*' and drinking wine with my two favorite disasters; hard to say no.

Calli and Zee exchange a look. Blair notices.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
What was that?

ZEE
What was what?

Blair narrows her eyes.

BLAIR
What the fuck did you two do?

Calli spins in her seat. Sheepish.

CALLI
Full disclosure?
(beat)
We might've low-key kidnapped you.

Realization hits. Hard.

BLAIR
Oh, fuck you. No— fuck you, Calli.

CALLI
It ain't just a party, okay? It's an opportunity.

BLAIR
To what? Reevaluate my entire life.

CALLI
Yeah. Maybe… It's time for you to evolve with the rest of us, B.

BLAIR
And what if I don't want to?

ZEE
Bitch, you can't stay Tier-1 forever.

CALLI
It's sink or swim.

Blair looks unimpressed.

BLAIR
…or drown.

ZEE
Or— fucking float like me, baby.

Calli softens.

CALLI
I don't know the details… whatever happened before we met?
(beat)
And I don't care. You're more than your past, B.

Blair fidgets. Her hands tremble. She pulls out a bottle of Prozac. Hesitates. Zee and Calli notice, but say nothing.

CALLI (CONT'D)
We're influencers, babe. We don't play by their rules. We rewrite them.

Blair exhales. Contemplates.

ZEE
Look, ain't nobody forcing your broke ass to come. If you ain't feelin' it, chill at the cabin 'til we're done.

Blair frowns.

BLAIR
I'm sorry— did you just say *"cabin"*?

Callie smiles innocently.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
You do realize a *cabin in the woods* is literally *the* killing grounds for every horror movie ever made, right?

ZEE
That's completely not true— Norman Bates owned a motel.

BLAIR
Seriously? That's your defense?

Calli rolls her eyes.

CALLI
Oh, fuck off. It's the *Eden Falls Retreat*. Sounds bougie as hell.

Blair shakes her head. She pops a couple *'happy pills'*.

ZEE
In her defense, so did the Overlook Hotel… Briarcliff Manor, Blackwood Pines Lodge, The Biltmore—

Calli punches him in the arm. Grinning.

CALLI
Yeah. Not helping, Zee.

She turns to Blair.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Look, just trust me, okay. This weekend is gonna slay. I promise.

She cocks an eyebrow.

CALLI (CONT'D)
You might even meet someone.

Blair rolls her eyes, but smirks. Zee sees it and pounces.

ZEE
Mmm. Yeah, girl. Clear out those cobwebs. Open the floodgates.
(beat)
(MORE)

ZEE (CONT'D)
Let him cast his *Patronus* up your *Chamber of Secrets.*

He thrusts dramatically. They cackle.

BLAIR
Oh my god. You are so disgusting.

CALLI
Speaking of floodgates…

She points out the window. A weathered sign— *WILLOW'S CREEK SALOON — 5 MILES.*

CALLI (CONT'D)
I really gotta pee.

INT. POLICE STATION - DAY

The place feels trapped in time. Creaking floors. Flickering fluorescents. Dusty case files stacked like headstones.

Rhea drops into her chair. Frank follows, coffee in hand.

FRANK
Hard to believe, huh? Two rookies scrapping for Alfie's approval… now look at us.

RHEA
Life's got a sick sense of humor.

Frank scans the room. Nostalgia. Regret. A long abandoned battlefield. Rhea watches him. Eyes focused.

RHEA (CONT'D)
So? You just here for nostalgia… or?

Frank smirks. Tosses a file onto her desk.

FRANK
Few years back we were tracking a crew outta Oak Haven. Live streaming illegal shit— graffiti, car-surfing, street racing— petty shit, mostly.

Rhea flips through images— masked teens mid-stunt.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Then, they started pushing the limits— goin' darker. More extreme, more violent… meant more views.

He hands her his phone. A video. She hits play.

GIRL (V.O.)
Cause if you're not being real… then what the fuck is the point?

The video jumps— screams, shaky footage, raw terror.

Rhea flinches. Slams the phone face-down.

RHEA
Jesus, Frank. Maybe lead with a trigger warning next time?

FRANK
That stream hit thirty million views before it was pulled.
(beat)
The spark that lit the fire.

She exhales— absorbing the weight.

RHEA
Snared?

Frank nods grimly.

FRANK
They launch a few months later— wipe out Facebook, TikTok, Insta— changes the game completely.

Rhea leans back, processing.

RHEA
Thirst traps and shitty dances are one thing… This is just chaos.

FRANK
Nah. It's not chaos— it's structure.

He flicks her a few screenshots. Sleek leaderboards. Gamified UI. Tiers. Comments. Badges.

FRANK (CONT'D)
A challenge is known as a *"Snare."* Tier-1 snare's are stupid pranks. Tier-2 gets a little more reckless—

RHEA
Rack up the views— you climb. Higher the tier, higher the risk. I know how it works… it's a glorified pyramid scheme for adrenaline junkies.

FRANK
At least they sold knives or vitamins… These fuckers just sell trauma in 4K.

Rhea scoffs.

RHEA
What's the prize— a little gold star?

FRANK
Crypto. Sponsors. Merch deals. But the real prize? Street cred. Most'll pick relevance over money every time.

RHEA
Most?

FRANK
You climb high enough… you rank up to an Architect. You stop taking snares. You start setting them.
(beat)
The elite don’t want clout. They want control.

Rhea scans a few more pages. She shakes her head. Disbelief.

RHEA
It’s a fucking app.

FRANK
Not to them. It’s their life.
(beat)
Their biggest fear isn't dying… it's dying unverified.

She grips the file tighter.

RHEA
And the girl from the video?

He slides over another folder.

FRANK
Gemma Beckett…

She scans it— redacted records, sealed files.

FRANK (CONT’D)
Bloodwork. Case files. Medical history— all fucking sealed.

RHEA
WitSec?

Frank nods. Convinced.

FRANK
Until fifteen years ago… Gemma Beckett didn’t exist.

Rhea looks up. Breath caught.

RHEA
Fifteen years— wait. You don’t think…?

Frank shrugs. She doesn't argue.

INT. SALOON — BAR - DAY

Stale beer and cigarette smoke cling to the faded band posters and taxidermy heads. The jukebox wheezes out some dying song.

ELSIE (65), sharp-tongued and steel-spined, polishes the bar.

TOUSLED LOCALS rot quietly on stools like they've never left.

The door creaks open— Zee, Blair, and Calli enter. Locals star. Conversations grind to a halt.

ZEE
(under breath)
Something tells me we're not in Kansas anymore.

CALLI
What, not glam enough for you?

ZEE
Oh, no. It's perfect… if your starring in a hate-crime doc.

Elsie clocks them with a wry smirk.

ELSIE
You kids lost?

Calli returns a sugary sweet smile.

CALLI
Just looking for the restroom.

Elsie gestures toward the back. Calli hooks Blair's arm. Drags her off.

Zee strides to the bar. His cocky grin countering the heavy judgmental stares.

ZEE
How y'all doin'?

The locals don't answer. Elsie doesn't blink.

ELSIE
This ain't no gas station.

Zee looks confused as hell.

ELSIE (CONT'D)
Ya gotta pay-to-pee.

Zee spots the hustle, but plays along.

ZEE
Guess I'm buying y'all a round.

Elsie grins. Starts pouring pints. The patrons don't budge.

INT. SALOON — FEMALE RESTROOM - DAY

Once-white walls, now stained a sickly yellow. Graffitied.

Blair cautiously leans against the sink. Disgusted.

DING! A notification—

— *@THE_RAVEN: HEY BLAIR. LONG TIME NO SEE.*

CALLI (O.S.)
Please tell me that's not Roman *orbiting* again.

BLAIR
Orbiting?

Blair frowns. She replies:

— *@CARE.BLAIR: WHO'S THIS?*

FLUSH! Calli exits a stall. Washes her hands.

CALLI
Y'know— liking all your shit, sliding into your DMs. Desperately letting you know—
(mocking)
"I'm still here…"

Blair chuckles. She steps into the—

TOILET STALL

She locks the door. Lines the seat with toilet paper.

BLAIR
He's not a bad guy, he's just—

Calli's voice echoes from outside.

CALLI (O.S.)
—Misunderstood? Girl, stop! He cheated with your cousin. That pin-dick is canceled.

DING!

— *@THE_RAVEN: AN OLD FRIEND.*

Blair frowns. Taps the profile. Empty.

— *@CARE.BLAIR: NICE FAKE PROFILE. SEE YA.*

DING! The response is immediate.

— *@THE_RAVEN: YOU'RE THE ONLY FAKE ONE HERE, BITCH.*

Her blood chills. Another ping— a video. Curiosity overrides instinct. She hits play.

GIRL (V.O.)
Cause if you're not being real… then what the fuck is the point?

She swipes it away. Breath caught in her throat. Silence.

CREAK! The bathroom door opens. Then— footsteps. Slow. Deliberate. They stop just outside her stall.

BLAIR
Calli?

BANG! Blair flinches. She peers down. A pair of Velcro shoes appear under the door— definitely not Calli's.

She freezes. Then—

KNOCK! KNOCK! KNOCK! She plays it cool.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Uhh… just a sec.

The door rattles violently. Blair shoots forward. Bracing it with her hand.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
What the fuck?! I said I'm in here!

The shaking intensifies. Louder. And louder, then— stops.

Her eyes snap to the shoes. Gone. She exhales. Shaking.

INT. SALOON — BAR - DAY (SAME TIME)

Zee and Calli wait for Blair. HAYDEN (32), unshaven and smug, slinks up beside Zee.

HAYDEN
Elsie! You didn't tell me it was fancy dress.

ELSIE
That's 'cause it ain't.

She slides him a pint. He sizes Zee up— a mean smile.

HAYDEN
Then what the fuck are you supposed to be? A hybrid?

Zee smirks.

ZEE
Oh baby boy… I'm more man than you'll ever be, and more woman than you could ever handle.

He gives a cheeky wink. Hayden's face falls flat.

ELSIE
You'll have to excuse Hayden. We don't get too many of your *type* 'round here.

ZEE
Is that Blacks? Or Queers?

Elsie takes a beat. She offers a sarcastic grin.

ELSIE
Millennials…

CALLI
Oh, I thought you meant people with good hygiene and a full set of teeth.

Elsie chuckles darkly.

ELSIE
Sluts like you are all the same— think you're better than everyone with your fat lips and fake tits.

CALLI
Oh honey— maybe you and your swamp people here need to look into getting some fake teeth.

Hayden scowls. He steps forward. Intimidating.

HAYDEN
Y'know, you got a big mouth, girl. Why don't we put it to good use?

Zee's whole energy shifts. His voice drops— hard. More masculine. More commanding.

ZEE
Yo, step the fuck off, Deliverance.

Hayden laughs.

HAYDEN
What're you gonna do, glitter boy?

Before anyone moves— Blair bursts in. Pale, Frantic.

BLAIR
We need to go. *Now.*

As she storms past, Hayden grabs her ass. Blair spins. Swings— he catches her fist mid-air.

HAYDEN
Feisty. That's my kind of—

BAM! She grabs his crotch. Tight.

BLAIR
Men like you don't get a *type*. You get restraining orders.

He wheezes. She stares into his eyes. Unblinking.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Now take your Gollum-lookin' ass… and fuck off.

Two of Hayden's CRONIES rise— blocking the exit.

ROMAN (O.S.)
Nice decor…

All heads turn. ROMAN, (25), Brooding. Magnetic. Stands in the doorway. Puffing his vape. He walks in.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
Got a real… Ed Gein meets Applebee's vibe.

He approaches Hayden. Notices he's still holding Blair's wrist. He smirks. Obnoxiously blowing a cloud of mist.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
Unless you wanna get your ass handed to you by a guy vaping *Peachy Mango Tango…* I'd suggest you remove that hand— get back to pickin' your banjo— or whatever the fuck it is that you do— and let my friends here, leave.

The tension snaps. Hayden releases Blair, laughing.

HAYDEN
Who the hell are you? His boyfriend?

Hayden motions to Zee.

ROMAN
Nah. But you can be *my* bitch.

Hayden stiffens. His jaw tight. Eyes wide.

HAYDEN
(venomous)
Faggot.

The word lands like a grenade. The bar goes silent.

Zee tightens his fists, jaw clenched. But, Roman steps in.

ROMAN
Oh, you did not just say that.

He's ready to swing. But— Zee stops him. Calm. Controlled.

ZEE
Let it go, Playa. It's just a word.

HAYDEN
Yeah, listen to your princess.

BAM! Zee pivots. A quick combo. Hayden's out cold.

ZEE
I ain't no princess… I'm a motherfuckin' Queen, bitch!

Hayden's cronies tense up, then—

CHICK-CHACK! Elsie racks a shotgun behind the bar.

ELSIE
I don't mind blood, boys. Just save it for happy hour.

Blair, Calli and Zee storm out.

ROMAN
Y'all are proof that some bloodlines should've ended with a coat hanger.

He smirks. Throws up the middle finger on his way out.

EXT. SALOON — PARKING LOT - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Sun blazes. Dust floats. They storm to Zee's car. Adrenaline pumping. Blair's fists clenched.

Roman jogs after them.

ROMAN
Blair!

She whips around—

WHACK! A clean right hook. Roman barely flinches.

BLAIR
I didn't need your help.

Roman shrugs. Honest. Wounded.

ROMAN
I know. Doesn't mean I can't try.

Her armor cracks— briefly. Then— Calli cuts in.

CALLI
What are you even doing here?

ZEE
I thought you ghosted all this chaos.

ROMAN
I'm done running. Figured it was time to face some old demons.

Blair laughs. Cold. Bitter.

BLAIR
Oh, cut the poetic bullshit, Roman. You're not even Tier-3.

Roman's grin flickers. Then returns.

ROMAN
And yet… here I am.

She shoves past him.

BLAIR
Stay out of my way this weekend.

She storms off. Calli follows. Roman winces, rubbing his jaw.

ZEE
Bitch, Hellen Keller could’ve seen that punch coming.

ROMAN
Yeah, well. She needed it.

ZEE
One hit ain’t gonna fix shit, Playa. She ain’t just pissed— she’s hurt.
(beat)
That shit takes time.

Roman exhales. Sharp. Defensive.

ROMAN
It was a fucking Snare, Zee. You *know* how this shit works.

Zee softens— just a touch.

ZEE
Don’t matter the tier, Ro. You fucked up.
(beat)
While I appreciate you stepping in back there, you gotta know I’m *‘Team Blair’* all the way, Hooker.

Zee heads for the car. Roman watches him go. Alone again.

FROM THE TREE LINE—

A shadowed figure watches Roman walk to his car. Engines roar. Both cars speed off.

The figure turns its head— from the road— to the saloon.

INT. ZEE’S CAR - DAY

The car is silent. Unnerving. Calli scrolls on her phone. Blair stares out the window. The world smears past in streaks.

BUZZ! A notification flashes on Blair’s phone—

— *@THE_RAVEN: DO YOU EVEN FEEL BAD FOR KILLING HER?*

Her breath catches. Hands tremble. She types.

— *@CARE.BLAIR: I DIDN’T KILL HER, ASSHOLE. SHE KILLED HERSELF.*

BUZZ! The reply comes fast.

— *@THE_RAVEN: ONE PERSON’S TRUTH… IS ANOTHER PERSON’S LIE.*

She flips the phone over.

The road hums beneath them. Her eyes drift shut. Breath slows. Sleep takes over then— she's out.

INT. SUBURBAN HOUSE — KITCHEN - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

SUPER: OAK HAVEN, KANSAS — 5 YEARS AGO

A house party mid-implosion. Sweat. Booze. Weed. Blow. Bodies grind. Bottles crash.

SLAM! The back door crashes open. Roman (20), stumbles in— bloodied. Arm wrapped in in a janky bandage.

BROCK (20), a muscle-bound bro, drags him in. Laughing.

His bronzed, gym-sculpted girlfriend SASHA (20) and ROXY (20) trail behind, phones up.

Blair (20) storms in, fury in her eyes. TARYN (20)— her seductive, shameless cousin— saunters in behind, smirking.

BLAIR
What the fuck were you thinking, Ro?

TARYN
Relax, *Mom.* It's just content.

Blair shoves Roman into a chair, inspecting the gash.

ROMAN
No risk, no reward, baby?

He winks. Blood smeared across his face like warpaint.

BLAIR
You went too far tonight.

SASHA
Too far? Babe, too far *is* the brand.

Cheers and high-fives.

BROCK
We're all just disposable content, B.
You gotta go big… or you disappear.

BLAIR
And if you die in the process?

Roxy snickers.

ROXY
Then at least we go viral.

Taryn raises a shot.

TARYN
Can't make an omelet without breaking a few eggs, Cuz.

Roman's glassy eyes drift to ZEE (20), gliding through the party. A girl and guy on each arm.

ROMAN
Queen Zee! Get your sexy ass over here!

Zee smirks. Detours for a shot.

ZEE
Y'all are outta your goddamn minds.

They drink. Laugh. But Zee notices Blair's mood.

ZEE (CONT'D)
(quietly)
You good?

Blair nods— barely. Zee pushes a shot toward her.

ZEE (CONT'D)
Drink, bitch. It helps.

He downs another shot— then vanishes into the chaos.

TARYN
(grinning)
Babe, they're calling you a fucking GOAT!

They crowd around her phone. Scrolling emojis and comments:

— *@BangerzOnly: ROMAN THE GOAT*
— *@SICKSADWORLD: BLOOD 4 THE LULZ*
— *@K0R3JUNKIE: BROHH… HOW IS HE NOT DEAD?*

Taryn brushes past Blair. Slides in next to Roman. Gripping his bicep. She throws Blair a wink— sharp and cruel.

Blair scoffs— rage simmering. She walks out— alone.

INT. SUBURBAN HOUSE — BACKYARD - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Blair steps into the crisp night air. A few deep breaths.

From the dark— GEMMA (20), emerges. Pale. Introvert. A faded scar across her cheek.

GEMMA
Hey, Blair-Bear.

Blair spins. Relief— then guilt.

BLAIR
Gem?! Shit, I haven't seen you since—

GEMMA
You ditched me. For the bitch squad?

Blair falters. No comeback. Gemma forces a smile.

GEMMA (CONT'D)
But hey, I get it.

A beat hangs— heavy.

Gemma's gaze drift to Blair's wrist— a beaded bracelet. The name, *'Blair'* spelled out in colorful beads.

GEMMA (CONT'D)
If you don't want us to be together…
why do you still wear it?

Blair looks down. Her voice catches.

BLAIR
It meant… it *means* a lot to me.

GEMMA
Doesn't seem like it.

Blair winces— *no easy way to fix this.*

BLAIR
Gem… What we had— I just…

Gemma smiles. Nod like she already knew.

GEMMA
That's actually why I came tonight.
(beat)
To say goodbye.

BLAIR
Goodbye? Wait, where are you—?

GEMMA
I'm not who you think I am, Blair.
(beat)
There's a whole other… life you don't
know about.

Blair frowns, confused.

BLAIR
What the hell does that mean?

GEMMA
It means… I'm going home. To my dad…
My foster sister.

BLAIR
Foster sister?

Gemma steps closer. Softer now.

GEMMA
She used to say, *"Life's too short to bury your emotions. Say what you feel. Before it's too late."*

She takes Blair's hand— a gentle, familiar moment.

GEMMA (CONT'D)
I love you, Blair.

Blair's armor cracks. She leans in. Scared but real. They kiss. Soft. Tentative. Then—

BANG! The door crashes open. The party spills out. Everyone freezes. Eyes wide.

Blair jerks back. Wipes her mouth on instinct.

BLAIR
What the fuck, Gem?

Gemma's smile dies. Hurt. Betrayed

Roman stumbles over— drapes an arm around Blair.

ROMAN
I thought you ditched her ass.

ROXY
She's a fucking stalker. What'd you expect?

SASHA
Let me guess. You're here to *rescue* her from the delinquents?

Gemma's eyes fill. She stares at Blair— gutted.

GEMMA
I *can't* save her. No one can.

Gemma turns to leave. Taryn steps forward- blocking her. Grinning. A jagged bottle in hand.

TARYN
Actually, Gem… I got an idea.

Phones are up. Cameras are streaming. Blair stiffens.

BLAIR
Taryn— don't.

TARYN
What? She cuts herself anyway.

Roxy grabs the shard. Forces it into Gemma's palm.

Gemma's eyes burn into Blair's.

GEMMA
Is this who you are now?

Blair says nothing. Gemma scoffs.

GEMMA (CONT'D)
Congratulations. You made it. You're just like them—
(beat)
You reek of desperation.

That lands. Blair snaps.

BLAIR
No. You're the desperate one— clinging to some fantasy you made up in your twisted little head.

She rips off the bracelet. Throws it at Gemma's feet.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Stop embarrassing yourself and move the *fuck on.*

Blair storms past Roman. He flinches— even he knows that went too far.

Gemma's expression shifts— a soft, hollow smile.

GEMMA
You spend your lives faking perfection. Performing. Filtering. Terrified someone might see the cracks— see that you're real.
(beat)
You don't even know who you are without the likes. And the truth is? You don't even care.
(beat)
Because being fake is easier than being forgotten.

Some phones lower. Most don't.

GEMMA (CONT'D)
So go ahead— laugh at me. Remix me. Turn me into a fucking meme and bury me in hashtags— I don't care. At least I'll know I was real.
(beat)
Cause if you're not being real… then what the fuck is the point?

SLASH! She rips the jagged glass across her throat. Blood sprays— dark and fast.

Phones drop. Screams rip. Chaos detonates, but Taryn— just stares. Not laughing. Not recording. Just still.

The bracelet slowly vanishes beneath a wave of red.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. ZEE'S CAR - DAY

Blair jolts awake. Gasping. Disoriented. Scanning the familiar interior. Reality floods back in. She exhales. Safe.

BANG! A fist slams the window. Blair jumps. Heart pounding.

OUTSIDE

Zee grins, phone in hand.

BLAIR
What the hell, Zee?

ZEE
Bitch, please. I'm the talent. Y'all should be carrying my shit.

EXT. CABIN - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Blair stumbles out, Shaken. Still flushed from the memory.

CALLI
Damn, girl. You were out before we hit the first turn.

BLAIR
Yeah, these… new meds. They're…

She trails off as her gaze lifts. A breathtaking cabin. Sleek. Modern. Elegant. Stone and wood. Floor-to-ceiling glass that reflect the glistening lake.

She smiles— unable to hide her awe.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Okay… I admit. It's better than the murder shack I was picturing.

CALLI
Oh my God. Was that a *smile*?

ZEE (O.S.)
(frantically)
No! No! Noooo!!!

The girls whip around. Zee holds his phone up. Distressed.

ZEE (CONT'D)
N-No signal.

Blair gasps. Clutching her chest in fake horror.

BLAIR
Just shoot now, post later.

Zee and Calli laugh. Then realize— she's serious.

ZEE
Bitch, does it look like 2008? Should I fax it to MySpace while I'm at it?

CALLI
Oh, Blair. You precious, unmonetized little fetus. You go live… or you don't go at all.

Zee shakes his head. Sneering, Disgusted.

ZEE
Have we taught you nothing?

They grab their bags and strut to the porch.

AT THE TREE LINE—

Something shifts. Still. Watching.

SNAP! A branch cracks underfoot. Blair spins. Nothing. Just wind and trees.

She exhales. Follows the others.

EXT. CABIN — FRONT DOOR - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Calli knocks. No response. She peers through the glass.

CALLI
Doesn't look like anyone's here.

ZEE
Honestly— I'm underwhelmed. I was expecting valets… maybe a couple hot, oiled-up Puerto Rican pool boys—

BLAIR
Are we sure it's the right place?

Calli gestures toward the pristine wooden sign:

"WELCOME TO EDEN FALLS RETREAT: REBUILDING HOPE, ONE STAY AT A TIME."

She deadpans at Blaire.

CALLI
Yup. Pretty sure.

Zee groans. Impatient. He jiggles the handle.

CLICK! It opens.

ZEE
Well. Guess we're expected.

He shrugs and heads inside.

BLAIR
Zee, maybe we should wai—

ZEE
What are they gonna do— tie us up and go all Leatherface on our asses?

BLAIR
Well, that's… always a possibility.

ZEE
Good. Cause chains and whips excite me.

He struts in.

CALLI
Did he just quote Rihanna?

Blair sighs.

BLAIR
This is gonna be a long weekend.

They grab their bags. Laughing. They follow Zee in.

INT. CABIN — FOYER - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Hardwood floors. Exposed beams. Cobblestone fireplace. Cozy. Rustic.

CALLI
Still think we're gonna get massacred with a chainsaw?

ALFIE (O.S.)
It's outta gas.

They freeze. A tense beat— then slowly turn.

Alfie steps out from a shadowed doorway. Wiping his hands on a grease-slicked rag. His eyes— quietly assessing.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
The chainsaw, that is. Sorry to disappoint.

The group stiffens— instinctively uneasy.

ALFIE (CONT'D) (CONT'D)
Y'know, most folks knock first.

ZEE
We did. You just didn't answer.

ALFIE
Maybe I was hopin' you'd take the hint.

The silence clings. Nervous laughter.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
So… what brings you kids all the way out here? Ain't for the hospitality, that's for damn sure.

ZEE
Only the biggest party of the year.

Alfie blinks. Blank.

CALLI
Snared?

Still nothing. Blair steps in. Throws him a lifeline.

BLAIR
It's a party… In Eden Falls.

Alfie nods slowly.

ALFIE
Right…

He nods—slow, almost reluctant.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
Well, as long as you don't turn my place into a zoo, you won't have to shovel shit in the morning.

Zee rolls his eyes. Still looking for a signal.

ZEE
Ah, speaking of shit— what's up with the cell service?

ALFIE
It's spotty at best. But I just had the Wi-Fi installed.

He points to a QR code taped to the wall: *SCAN ME FOR WI-FI.*

ALFIE (CONT'D)
It's this invisible internet— no wires— just works like magic.

They chuckle. But Alfie narrows his gaze.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
I thought there'd be more of you—

Before anyone responds—

SCREEECH! HONK!

IN THE DRIVEWAY

A flashy sports car skids into the gravel. Doors fly open—Brock, Sasha, and Taryn (25), pour out. Bags in hand.

IN THE FOYER

Blair glares at Calli— *if looks could kill.* Calli offers a sheepish smile. She sneaks away.

The *posse* approach. Toss duffels at Alfie's feet.

BROCK
Cover your eyes, Pops. Wouldn't want you strokin' out.

Sasha giggles. Groping Brock.

SASHA
We're raiding your Viagra stash.

They march inside. Taryn saunters up.

TARYN
Fuck me in the ass— this is lit AF.

She eyes Blair up and down.

TARYN (CONT'D)
Hey, Cuz. Still rocking the whole *"repressed virgin"* aesthetic?

BLAIR
Well, some call it *self-respect.*

TARYN
Influencer 101, babe. Pick your currency— tits or ass.

BLAIR
Oh, so that's what rock bottom looks like.

Taryn smirks. Backing into the chaos.

TARYN
Sweetie… jealousy is not your color.
(beat)
Then again— nothing is.

She struts inside. Blair exhales. Alfie leans in.

ALFIE
I should probably go gas up that chainsaw.

BLAIR
Only if you leave it with me.

He smirks. Heads out. Blair moves to the—

LIVING ROOM

Sasha's already streaming. Brock yells at the camera.

BROCK
Strap the fuck in, you viral misfit degenerates— shit's about to explode! *Let's fuckin' go!*

POP! Champagne sprays. Pre-party drinks have officially begun.

I/E. CABIN — SNARE MONTAGE - LATE AFTERNOON

Screams. Flash cuts. Filters. Chaos. Day turns to night through a brutal, boozy blur.

· They shotgun beers. Blair gags. Brock crushes his empty can against his forehead with a primal yell.
— SNARE COMPLETE: SKULL CRUSHER — 800 VIEWS

· Blair eats a ghost pepper. Calm… until it hits. Tears. Sweating. Frantic dancing.
— SNARE COMPLETE: HOT MESS EXPRESS — 1.2K VIEWS

· Zee performs a lap dance on Brock. Brock "makes it rain."
— SNARE COMPLETE: POLE PATROL — 1.9K VIEWS

· Brock— in drag— attempts a death drop. Zee coaches. He fails gloriously.
— SNARE COMPLETE: GLAM SLAM — 2.6 VIEWS

· Wax strips rip off Brock's chest. He shrieks.
— SNARE COMPLETE: WAX ON, WAX OFF — 3.4K VIEWS

· Strip pong. Bikini tops slingshot across the room. Taryn loses a round and her patience.
— SNARE COMPLETE: STRIP PONG — 4.7K VIEWS

· Naked cannonball into the lake. Brock reemerges. Cold. Confident. Questionable shrinkage.
— SNARE COMPLETE: BLUE BALLS — 6.2K VIEWS

· Taryn takes a slow, suggestive body shot off Sasha. They make out. Streamers go feral.
— SNARE COMPLETE: TEQUILA SUNRISE — 7.9 VIEWS

· Zee hunched over a chair. Brock tattoos "Insert Here !" on his lower back. Permanent. Unbalanced. Regret-proof.
— SNARE COMPLETE: BAD INK — 10K VIEWS

INT. POLICE STATION - LATE AFTERNOON

Rhea sits hunched at her desk, crunching through a bag of crisps. Thumbing through a case file.

Across from her— Frank skims old reports. Knee bouncing with restrained energy.

RHEA
I don't buy it. No way a kid vanishes that clean. How the hell would she even get into WitSec?

FRANK
Survival's one helluva motivator. I mean— Crowe disappeared, right?

Rhea glares— unimpressed.

RHEA
That's because he's dead.

Frank scoffs, undeterred.

FRANK
One of the phones I tracked last night belonged to Roxy Anderson. Part of the same Oak Haven crew that pushed Gemma to—

Rhea laughs. Mockingly. Rubbing her face.

RHEA
Okay… Wait. So you're saying, after fifteen years Christian Crowe just strolls into town, buys a cell phone, and thinks—
(mocking)
"Fuck it. I'm gonna give this influencer thing a shot.

Frank sighs— not amused.

FRANK
No. But someone's helping him.
(beat)
Someone who survived that night.

Rhea's expression hardens.

RHEA
Crowe slaughtered everyone, Frank.

FRANK
Not Hayden.

Rhea rubs her temples, groaning.

RHEA
Hayden's a fucking moron. He wears Velcro shoes 'cause he can't tie his own damn laces.

Frank drops a list of names. Hundreds. Most highlighted.

RHEA (CONT'D)
Lila Santos— *Buried Alive*. Lucas Raines— *Classroom Carnage*. Ashley Vega— *Border Mule*. Amir Zayed— *Kaboom!*

She flips the page. More names. More highlights.

RHEA (CONT'D)
What am I looking at?

FRANK
Everyone who streamed Gemma's suicide that night.

Rhea's taken aback.

RHEA
And the highlighted ones?

FRANK
All listed as *Snared* fatalities.

Her fingers tighten on the list.

FRANK (CONT'D)
And the kicker? Their final Snares were sent from the same Architect— *"The Raven."*

Rhea sets the file down. Slow. Processing.

RHEA
You think it's a kill list?

He shrugs. She stares at him. Cold. Calculating.

RHEA (CONT'D)
I mean, you hear yourself, right? You sound *insane.*
(beat)
She died, Frank.

Frank hesitates. Something darker flickers behind his eyes.

FRANK
We didn't ID all the bodies, Rhea.

Rhea looks at him confused. Her voice sharpens.

RHEA
What the hell are you talking about?

FRANK
We couldn't. Blood was mixed. Limbs were everywhere.
(beat)
Alfie made the call. Give the town some closure. Let 'em believe what they needed to.

Rhea's hands curl into fists.

RHEA
You better be fucking kidding me.

FRANK
If it went sideways… you'd have plausible deniability.
(MORE)

FRANK (CONT'D)
(beat)
We were just trying to protect you.

Rhea stands. Her rage explodes.

RHEA
Bullshit. You weren't protecting me.

FRANK
All I'm saying is— if Hayden made it out… maybe others did too.

BAM! Rhea slams her fists on the desk.

RHEA
Get your shit.

She grabs her keys. Slides on her jacket.

RHEA (CONT'D)
We're paying Alfie a visit.

Frank gathers his files, trailing her out.

FRANK
You think he'll talk?

RHEA
He doesn't have a *fucking* choice.

INT. SALOON — BAR - NIGHT

Hayden slouches at the bar. A half-empty beer in hand. Elsie closes the till behind him.

ELSIE
Guess I'm driving your sorry ass home *again*?

HAYDEN
Depends. You drivin' me home— or back to your place *again*?

She smirks— then

BANG! Something slams out back. They freeze.

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
The fuck was that?

ELSIE
Check the alley. I'll finish up.

HAYDEN
The fuck I look like?

ELSIE
Like someone three years deep on his bar tab.

He grumbles. Pushes through the back door.

EXT. SALOON — BACK ALLEY - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

The flickering backlight buzzes. Hayden squints into the dark.

BANG! A clatter— inside the dumpster.

HAYDEN
Alright, motherfucker. I ain't in the mood for games—

He edges toward the bin, as—

REEAK! A raccoon explodes out— claws flying. Hayden screams— stumbles back. Lands hard.

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
Fuck you. Goddamn crackhead-ass raccoon…

He spits. Dusts himself off. Heads back inside.

INT. SALOON — BAR - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

The door slams behind him.

HAYDEN
It was that fuckin' racco—

He stops. Elsie's gone. It's empty.

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
Els?

No answer. He walks toward his beer.

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
(muttering)
Why the fuck's it always a raccoon?

He picks up his beer. Skols it. Then— his eyes catch the bar mirror. A shiver runs down his spine.

Behind him— a reflection. *CHRISTIAN CROWE. A*xe slung over his shoulder. Hollow, black eyes.

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
Oh fuck—

CRACK! Crowe slams Hayden's head into the bar. Blood spills.

Crowe spins Hayden around— pins him. One hand on his throat. The other tears open Hayden's shirt— a jagged scar across his torso— *a brutal reminder of the past.*

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
P-Please, Mr. Crowe… I ain't that guy no more…

Crowe tightens his grip.

SMASH! SMASH! SMASH!

Hayden looks up. Blood gushing. His face a mess.

Crowe forces his mouth onto the bar's edge— teeth grinding against the wood.

HAYDEN (CONT'D)
No—please—stop—

CRUNCH! Crowe hammers the back of Hayden's skull. Blood and teeth explode across the bar.

CREAK! Crowe turns as Elsie appears from the cellar— case of beer in hand.

ELSIE
I forgot to restock th—

She sees him. Drops the case. Glass shatters. Her voice shaky.

ELSIE (CONT'D)
I always knew you'd come back.

A bitter laugh escapes her.

ELSIE (CONT'D)
Guess some bloodlines really are cursed.

A beat, then— Elsie goes to run.

THWACK! Crowe flicks a knife from the bar. The blade buries in Elsie's eye. Sending her tumbling down the cellar steps.

Crowe stands over the carnage. Silent. Unforgiving.

INT. CABIN — LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Music hums. Half-empty bottles scatter the table. Blair, Calli, and Zee play *King of Cards.*

From upstairs— Moans. Banging. They pause. Exchange a look. Burst out laughing.

BUZZ! Blair's phone vibrates. Calli grabs it.

CALLI
This orbiting motherf—

She stops. Her smile fades.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Who the fuck is *"The Raven"?*

The moaning upstairs stops. Blair snatches it back.

BLAIR
No-one—

ZEE
Ominous much?

Calli narrows her eyes. Intrigued.

CALLI
Y'know… in Navajo mythology, ravens are protectors.

She pauses. A subtle shift.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Then again— Norse myth— they're all about revenge, so…

Blair studies her.

BLAIR
Why do you know so much about ravens?

Calli shrugs. Deflecting.

CALLI
Why do you know so much about Inuit throat singing?

Absolute confusion.

BLAIR
…I don't.

ZEE
Bitch, you should. That shit slaps.

Before Blair can respond— Taryn and Sasha bounce down the stairs, glowing. Brock follows— shirtless. Dazed. Regretful.

BROCK
Fuck you, Zee. That had nothing to do with a clothes peg.

DA-DING!
— SNARE COMPLETE: DOUBLE DIP — 12K VIEWS

They laugh like a pack of hyena's. Then—

WHOOP! WHOOP! WHOOP! Zee's alarm blares.

ZEE
Alright, bitches— two hours to glam up. And I ain't showin' up lookin' like an extra on *'The Walking Dead.'*

Calli eyes Blair. Smirking.

CALLI
You got first shower… We got a whole lotta work to do.

Blair groans, rising.

BLAIR
(sarcastic)
Oh, yay. A makeover montage.

She heads out.

INT. ALFIE'S HOUSE – LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

A time capsule of neglect– old case files. Faded awards. Dim. Dusty. A whiskey glass sweats on the table– ice still whole.

Rhea steps inside, grimacing at the mess.

RHEA
Jesus, Alfie. Ever heard of spring cleaning?

Frank spots the fresh drink. The cold glass.

RHEA (CONT'D)
Maybe he left?

Frank shakes his head.

FRANK
One thing I know? He'd never waste a drop of whiskey.

Frank glances up the dark hall. He calls out.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Ain't that right, Alfie?

CREAK! Footsteps from the hall. Alfie appears– duffle in hand. Tired. Weathered.

ALFIE
You'd think I was already toe-tagged with the way you're sniffin' around.

Rhea doesn't flinch.

RHEA
Not our fault your house smells like a morgue.

He smirks. Drops into his chair.

RHEA (CONT'D)
Taking a trip?

Alfie shrugs.

ALFIE
I was thinking about it. Maybe laying low till the circus blows over.
(beat)
Can't stomach another drop of blood.

Frank nods. Sympathetic.

FRANK
Might be a smart idea.

Rhea crosses her arms.

RHEA
Not before I get some fucking answers.

He turns to Frank.

ALFIE
I'm guessing you finally came clean.

Frank nods. Alfie accepts. He takes a sip of whiskey. Slow. Deliberate. The silence stretches. Then— he leans in.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
You sure you want to know?

The room chills.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
Because once you know— I got no way to protect you.

Frank straightens. Rhea doesn't flinch— cold as ice.

RHEA
Start fucking talking.

INT. CABIN — BATHROOM - NIGHT

Steam curls. She tests the water— just right. She checks her phone.

— *@THE_RAVEN: SHE BEGGED FOR HELP. JUST LIKE YOU WILL.*

Her stomach knots. Her fingers fly.

— *@CARE.BLAIR: WELL KEEP WATCHING, ASSHOLE. I'M DONE PLAYING THIS GAME.*

SEND! She tosses the phone. Starts undressing.

— *BUZZ! INCOMING CALL: UNKNOWN NUMBER.*

She stares. It rings. And rings— *NEW VOICEMAIL.* She hesitates. Hits play. A distorted, broken voice.

VOICE
(on phone)
You should've answered, Blair-Bear…
Now they'll bleed for your silence.

CLICK! Silence. Thick. Oppressive. The lights flicker— then die. Total darkness.

She flicks on her phone flashlight. Opens the door.

HALLWAY

Blair steps out. Steam clings to her skin. Her phone flashlight slices through the dark. Tension climbs. She swallows hard.

BLAIR
(whispering)
Guys? Zee? Calli?

THUD! She jolts.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
This isn't funny!

BANG! A door slams. She whirls around—

Calli. Covered in blood. Hands clutching her throat. Blood seeps between her fingers.

CALLI
(gurgling)
B-Blair… help—

Before Blair can move—

A shape looms behind Calli. A figure— wearing a grotesque BABY-FACE MASK. It tilts its head. Locks onto Blair. Then—

It charges.

Blair screams. Runs—

STAIRCASE

She barrels down— only to stop cold.

At the bottom— a figure in a CRACKED PORCELAIN DOLL MASK, holding a phone— streaming. They wave. Mocking.

CLANG! She pivots. Behind her, a third figure in a TEDDY BEAR MASK— dragging a fireplace poker along the wall.

Blair whips around— the front door. Open. Hope ignites. She bolts—

FRONT DOOR

But— Another figure wearing a RABBIT MASK with crimson matted fur— blocks her escape.

She skids to a stop. Trapped.

Rabbit inches toward her. She backs away—

FOYER

They close in. Silent. Unrelenting.

Her chest heaves. Hands shaking. Eyes darting. No exits. Then—

Calli— still blood-soaked— stumbles through the masked figures. She reaches Blair and— smirks.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Got'cha.

The masks come off. Taryn. Sasha. Brock. Zee. All grinning. Gasping. High off the chaos.

DA-DING!
— SNARE COMPLETE: SCARED SHITLESS — 18K VIEWS

Blair's eyes blaze.

TARYN
Bet that Prozac's workin' overtime now.

BLAIR
What the fuck is wrong with you people?

Zee raises his hands. A mock surrender.

ZEE
Okay, Asshole move. I'll own it. But we're just tryin' to get you back in the game, B.

Her breathing slows. Anger crystalizing.

BLAIR
I don't want back in.

Calli smirks— almost impressed.

CALLI
Look at you. Growing a spine.

But the softness is brief. Her grin sharpens.

CALLI (CONT'D)
But now's not the time for it, B.

TARYN
Yeah. And I'm not missing this party 'cause you decided to have another one of your *'episodes.'*

BLAIR
Wow. Ok. You know what. Fuck you. And fuck this party. I'm not going.

The group laugh. Peeling away. Zee and Calli linger. Watching.

ZEE
Aww. It's like she has a choice.

CALLI
I know. Cute, right?

Blair steps closer. Steel in her voice.

BLAIR
I do have a choice. I *always* have a choice. And I'm telling you—
(beat)
I'm not going to that party—

SMASH CUT TO:

EXT. PARTY MANSION — FRONT LAWN - NIGHT

A decadent mansion glows under fairy lights. *Snared* elites strut through the lush grounds.

Designer outfits. Drunken ambition. Wealth. Artificial authenticity— just enough desperation to fuel a reality show.

The group arrives. Blair trails behind, tugging at her dress. Uncomfortable.

CALLI
Alright people— masks on. Game time.

Taryn tosses a smirk over her shoulder.

TARYN
In other words— lose the resting bitch face and fucking smile.

Blair flashes a twisted, monster grin.

BLAIR
Better?

Zee recoils, cackling.

ZEE
Oh god no. That's nightmare fuel. Never do that again.

Brock— already buzzing— slings an arm around Zee.

BROCK
So, you got those… party favors?

Zee lifts his brow. Brock digs into Zee's bra— he whips out a small pouch of pills.

Sasha and Taryn snatch theirs. Brock pops two. Calli downs one. But Blair doesn't flinch.

BLAIR
Oh, so you're a drug dealer now?

Zee gasps, clutching his chest.

ZEE
Ex-squeeze me, bitch? I ain't no gas-station, Adderall slingin' junkie.
(beat)
I'm a goddamn entrepreneur. An intermediary. A mover. A shaker. A leisure and pleasure maker. A dopamine creator. I'm a—

CALLI
Yeah. Okay. We get it. You're rebranding.

The group moves ahead. Blair lags behind— Zee and Calli close in beside her.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Look, B— you're about to walk into a fucking circus… but we got you, okay. *All the way.*

Blair exhales. Some of the armor slips.

ZEE
Just don't let her get to you tonight.

BLAIR
Who?

CALLI
Who?! The walking filter with daddy issues and a superiority complex.

Blair looks at Zee.

ZEE
Not me, bitch. Your skank-ass cousin.

Calli spots someone in the distance. She waves. Heads over.

CALLI
I'm gonna go flash my tits at opportunity. I'll see inside.

She bounces off. Zee and Blair approach the entrance.

ZEE
I know why you ain't all in yet.

Blair's eyes lock with Zee's.

ZEE (CONT'D)
But you can't carry her forever, B.
(beat)
She'll crush you.

Blair hesitates. The anger. The doubt.

BLAIR
I can't just forget her, Zee?

Zee's demeanor shifts. No jokes. No filter. Just raw truth.

ZEE
You don't have to. Just gotta figure out why any of this shit matters.

BLAIR
Why does it matter to you?

They stop at the entrance. Zee takes her hands. Grounding.

ZEE
I grew up as the only Black *and Queer* kid in a neighborhood that was one bad election away from burning crosses.
(beat)
But you know what my mamma told me?

Zee leans in. Direct.

ZEE (CONT'D)
"Own your shit! Life's got its claws in every motherfucker— it's how you fight back that makes you a motherfuckin' boss."

Blair chuckles.

BLAIR
Your mom really said that?

ZEE
Nah. She mostly threw shoes. But the old bitch had sprit.

Blair laughs. Tension subsides.

ZEE (CONT'D)
We all out here chasing something— views, likes, control. But underneath…
(beat)
It's about telling the world who the fuck you are. What you're worth— before someone else decides for you.

She nods— a crack forming in her defenses.

ZEE (CONT'D)
Life's just a game, baby girl. You either play it, or it plays you.

Zee drops a pill into her hand.

ZEE (CONT'D)
Now pop it— 'cause we about to shut. This. Bitch. *DOWN.*

Blair hesitates— *FUCK IT!— POP!*

EXT. SNARED PARTY MONTAGE - NIGHT

— Champagne towers. Glowing drinks. Neon veins pulse across the walls.

— DJ FOXXY NOIR (23), a glitter-drenched goddess in a metallic bikini, commands from her LED throne.

— The Snared logo pulses with the bass— hypnotic. Addictive.

DJ FOXXY NOIR
This ain't a party— it's a movement! *Eden Falls! Let's make some motherfucking noise!*

Music surges. The crowd detonates.

— Confetti cannons. DANCERS grinding in cage-rigged towers.

— Bare bodies crash into the pool.

— Vapes. Shots. Lines. Tongues. Girls and girls. Girls and guys. Guys and guys. A glorious blur of sweat and ego.

Blair freezes. Too loud. Too much. Too exposed. Zee grabs her.

ZEE
Bitch, I was *born* for this.

He pulls her into the swarm of sweaty bodies.

The same scene— five years later. Older. Sleeker. Louder. Meaner. But nothing's really changed.

INT. ALFIE'S HOUSE — LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

The room is dim. Silence thick. Alfie slumps in his weathered recliner. Rubbing a tired hand over his face.

Rhea and Frank sit across from him. Tense.

ALFIE
…My old buddy in WitSec set her up in Kansas— small town called Oak Haven. New name. New life. New family.

Rhea flinches— betrayal simmering.

RHEA
And you couldn't trust us with it?

ALFIE
Wasn't about trust. The fewer that knew— the safer she was.

Rhea springs to her feet.

RHEA
Make clear-headed decisions based on facts and evidence, not emotions.
(MORE)

RHEA (CONT'D)
(beat)
Logic over impulse. You taught us that.

Alfie leans forward. His voice, rough. Flat.

ALFIE
Yeah. When I was a little more naive, and believed the system still worked.

That lands. Hard. Rhea's jaw tightens.

RHEA
You let an *entire town* grieve for her… You let *me* grieve for her.

Frank softens, but keeps his tone firm.

FRANK
We grieved for all of them.

Rhea doesn't look at him. Eyes still locked on Alfie.

RHEA
I want to know when breaking the law become a *fucking* option to you?

Alfie bites back.

ALFIE
When a kid, covered in blood looked at me like I was her last goddamn hope.

A heavy silence settles.

FRANK
It might get pretty lonely up there on your moral high ground, Rhea.

Her glare cuts like glass.

RHEA
Oh, so now you're taking his side?

FRANK
We're all on the same side. And we've all done shady shit.
(beat)
If it's for the right reasons— what does it matter?

Rhea scoffs. Runs a frustrated hand through her hair. Pacing.

RHEA
Fifteen years, Alfie. Do you have any idea how much that hurts?

Alfie meets her eyes. Nods. Genuine.

ALFIE
I do.
(beat)
But this is bigger than your feelings, Rhea.

Rhea sinks back into her seat. Silent. Defeated.

Then— Frank's expression shifts. Something clicks.

FRANK
Those kids at your cabin— you find out why they're here?

Alfie shrugs.

ALFIE
Ah, some content party in Eden Falls.

Rhea stiffens. Frank pales.

FRANK
Shit… Must be the *Snared* party.

Rhea bolts up, fire reigniting.

RHEA
We need to move. Now.

She storms for the door— Frank grabs her wrist. She freezes. Glaring at his grip. He lets go. Hands raised.

FRANK
We go in hot, Crowe gets spooked, he vanishes— we lose everything.

Alfie's voice cuts through. Calm. Final.

ALFIE
We get one shot. Let's do it right.
(beat)
Logic over impulse.

A soft forgiving smile. Rhea accepts it. Swallows her rage. Thinks. Then— an idea flickers behind her eyes.

RHEA
Then we need eyes inside. Someone who blends.

Frank thinks, then— smiles.

FRANK
I know just the person.

He starts dialing.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Better yet… they're probably already there.

Alfie and Rhea trade a look— uncertain.

INT. PARTY MANSION — MAIN STAGE - NIGHT

Chaos. Sweat. Bass. Bodies drenched. Strobes slash the air like lightning.

Blair, Calli, and Zee grind with a drug-fueled abandon.

AT THE EDGE

Roman watches. Brooding. Beer in hand. Eyes locked on Blair— laughing. Spinning. Free in a way she rarely allows.

QUINN (O.S.)
This is living, huh?

Roman doesn't look away.

ROMAN
Depends on your definition, I guess.

QUINN (25), exuding quick wit and effortless charm, appears beside him. Soaking in the energy.

QUINN
Name's Quinn.

Roman shakes his hand. Barely.

ROMAN
Roman.

Quinn tracks Roman's gaze to Blair.

QUINN
Who's the cute brunette?

Roman's jaw ticks. Doesn't answer. Quinn smirks.

QUINN (CONT'D)
Oof. Judging by those *unhinged ex vibes*— I'm guessing she's off-limits?

Roman cracks a faint smile.

ROMAN
That obvious, huh?

QUINN
Only 'cause I've worn that face, Dude.

Quinn shifts his eyes to Calli— spinning. Wild. Reckless.

QUINN (CONT'D)
What about the friend?

ROMAN
Single… but she bites.

Quinn grins. Already moving— *Snare accepted.*

QUINN
Perfect. I like teeth.

Roman watches— unsure if he wants to follow or flee.

INT. PARTY MANSION — DANCE FLOOR - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Quinn cuts through the crowd. Smooth. Effortless. He stops at Blair and Calli.

QUINN
(shouting over the music)
Hey, uh— are you from Tennessee?

The girls exchange a look.

CALLI
Tennessee? No. Why?

QUINN
'Cause, I'm lookin' around, but…
you're the only ten I see.

Blair and Calli burst out laughing.

CALLI
Oh my God. That was so bad… but
you're kinda cute.

He joins their orbit. Blair side-eyes him.

BLAIR
Just dancing, though. No fuckboys
allowed.

QUINN
Lucky for me— I'm fuckboy-adjacent.

BLAIR
That's exactly what a fuckboy would
say.

They laugh. Dance. But something shifts—

Blair's face pales. Vision blurs. Music warps. Lights smear.

Quinn leans in, concerned.

QUINN
Hey— are you okay?

CALLI
She's fine. First time on E. She'll
level out.

QUINN
Maybe we should—?

Calli grabs him. Kisses him. Grinds against him. He forgets the question.

Blair stumbles back. Grips the railing. The room tilts. Heart pounding. She tries to breathe— tries to find the air—

She falls, but- Roman catches her.

ROMAN
You good?

Her lips move— barely audible.

BLAIR
I… I just need—

ROMAN
Let's get you outside.

He doesn't wait. He slips an arm around her. Guiding her out.

INT. PARTY MANSION — WOODS - NIGHT

Branches loom like skeletal fingers. Bass from the party pulses faintly— an eerie heartbeat beneath the stillness.

Sasha and Brock stumble through the dark. Drunk. High. Horny. Giggling between sloppy kisses.

He fumbles with her bra. She moans— clawing at his jeans. They crash to the ground.Frantic. Primal.

CRUNCH! Leaves underfoot.

Sasha freezes. Her head snaps toward the trees.

SASHA
(whispers)
What was that?

The wind rustles. Branches creak. Brock's too horny to care.

BROCK
Probably just a raccoon.

She hesitates, then—

SNAP! A twig. Closer this time. She stiffens.

SASHA
Babe… stop. I think someone's out here.

Brock barely reacts. Thrusting.

BROCK
So? Let 'em watch.

She gasps— caught between fear and lust. Then— she gives in. Moaning. Back arching. Fingers digging into the dirt. Her eyes flutter open, mid-thrust.

Christian Crowe looms above. Still. Silent. The axe, perched on his massive shoulder.

Sasha's breath catches mid-moan.

SASHA
(panicked)
Brock! BROCK! *FUCK!*

She thrashes. Slaps at his chest.

BROCK
Damn, baby… yeah, that's—

THUNK! A sickening crunch. Flesh tears. Bone cracks. Blood spurts.

Brock spasms. His eyes bulging. Then— goes limp. She screams. Pinned under his body.

Crowe steps forward. Calm. Steady. He yanks the axe free with a wet squelch.

Sasha shoves Brock's body aside. Scrambling backward. Gasping.

WHOOSH! WHOOSH! The axe slices past her face— narrow misses.

SASHA
(sobbing)
Please… Please. Don't—

CRACK! Crowe's boot crushes her ankle. Bone punches through skin. Her scream rips through the woods.

Crowe drops to a knee. Straddles her. She fights. Claws. Desperately reaching for a rock. A branch- anything.

His hands clamp around her head like a vise. Thumbs pressing into her eyes—

She screeches. Raw. Animalistic terror. Her body bucks, then—

POP! A wet, visceral rupture. Stillness. Blood weeping from empty sockets.

EXT. PARTY MANSION — PATIO - NIGHT

Blair sips orange juice. Her breathing calms. Pulse returning to baseline. Roman watches.

ROMAN
How you feeling?

Blair nods. Drained.

BLAIR
Better.

She looks up— embarrassed, but sincere.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Thank you.

Roman hesitates, then- reaches into his pocket. He pulls out the colorful beaded *"Blair"* bracelet.

She freezes. Her fingers tremble as she takes it.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Where did you—

ROMAN
Some fed showed up a while back. He knew about Gemma. Bout that night.

Blair's stomach twists.

BLAIR
What did he want?

ROMAN
Answers.
(beat)
After beating the shit out of me— he showed me some things that didn't add up. Said Gemma Beckett… wasn't who we thought she was.

Blair's throat tightens. A memory flares.

BLAIR
She said the same thing that night.

ROMAN
He showed me a list. Hundreds of names. Everyone who streamed it. All dead— except us. Not yet anyway.

Blair's brow furrows. Trying to anchor herself.

BLAIR
The Raven?

ROMAN
Shit. You too?

Blair nods. Roman exhales.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
It's gotta be Gemma, right? Wanting revenge for what we did.

BLAIR
Gem-? No. What?- She's dead, Roman. This is just someone fucking with us. Playing some sick game.
(MORE)

BLAIR (CONT'D)
(beat)
Or maybe— it's you.

ROMAN
Me? You think that I-

BLAIR
Why not? Plant the seed. Trigger a spiral. Reel me back in.

Roman's jaw clenches. Her words hit harder than she knows.

ROMAN
Wow. You've really nailed the martyr act, huh?

Blair glares at him.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
That night fucking destroyed me, Blair. It destroyed us.

BLAIR
No. *You* destroyed us. When you fucked my cousin.

A sharp beat— raw and jagged. Before Roman can answer—

TARYN (O.S.)
Aww, you two lovebirds want a room?

They're interrupted— Zee, Taryn, Calli, and Quinn arrive.

ROMAN
Actually, I'm looking for Marcus.

ZEE
Marcus?! My walking-true-crime-sub-Reddit cousin, Marcus?

ROMAN
Yeah. I was his plus-one.

Taryn eyes him, skeptical.

TARYN
Bullshit. Marcus isn't even here.

ROMAN
Yeah. That's kinda the point, Taryn.

Zee frowns.

ZEE
He's supposed to be. So are Wes, Roxy and Lazaria.

Taryn checks her phone.

ROMAN
I've been calling. But no answer.

ZEE
Same. Figured I'd catch him here.
Kinda got distracted.

Taryn stops scrolling. Eyes flicking up.

TARYN
Shit— they're all offline.
(beat)
So are Sasha and Brock.

CALLI
Didn't she just drag his ass into the woods?

BLAIR
Maybe they're setting up a Snare?

Zee considers.

ZEE
Marcus was chasing Tier-4 this weekend.

QUINN
But why go dark?

Then— the music cuts. A burst of static. A bone-chilling scream from the speakers. They bolt.

INT. PARTY MANSION — DANCE FLOOR - NIGHT

The party grinds to a halt. Crowd frozen. Eyes locked on the massive LED screen. A video plays—

Roxy dangles from rafters— shoulders grotesquely bulging from their sockets. A noose of razor blades tight around her neck.

The *Snared* logo hovers in the corner. A timer blinks: *00:59… 00:58…*

ROXY
(panicked)
Please— Why are you doing this?

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. KILL ROOM - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

Dark. Windowless. Flickering light.

Roxy hangs above a bed of nails. Ankles bound. Feet bloodied. Razor noose biting deep.

Her phone streams it all— viewers climbing.

ROXY
Please… Stop— I'll do anything.

INTERCUT — PARTY/ KILL ROOM

The timer ticks: *00:17… 00:16…* Scrolling emojis and comments:

— *@K1LLRKLOUT: BITCH BE GETTIN' MURKED!*
— *@FMLSTREAM: RAZOR NOOSE? DAMN. ETSY LINK??*
— *@NOSAFEWORD: SHE'S LIKE MY EX… FAKIN' IT, LOL*

Blair watches— horrified.

BLAIR
Is that… Roxy?

Roman joins her side. They both know— it's real.

ROXY (ON SCREEN)
P-Please… I'm sorry.

Roxy's arms shake violently. Unable to hold on. Her screams, raw. The razor noose digs in. Then— she slips.

INT. PARTY MANSION — DANCE FLOOR - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

SQUELCH! The razor noose slices through her throat. The screen distorts. Then— blackness.

The party is frozen. No music. No voices. Just a stunned unnatural silence. Then—

An error message flashes across the LED screen:

— *YOU JUST BROKE THE FUCKING INTERNET. #SNARED.*

The crowd erupts. Phones go up— *a meme in the fucking making.*

DJ Foxxy Noir drops the beat. The music kicks back in.

But— the energy's shifted. Strange looks. Forced smiles. Laughter just a little too loud— *a creeping paranoia sinks in.*

EXT. ORPHANAGE — PADDOCK - NIGHT

Alfie treks through a tangle of weeds and broken branches.

He pauses. Stares up at the rotting monument. Pain. Regret. Betrayal. His gaze drifts to the attic window—

A shadow glides past the cracked glass.

Alfie's jaw tightens. His hand instinctively drops to the .38 revolver on his hip.

He exhales. Steps forward.

EXT. PARTY MANSION — OUTSIDE BAR - NIGHT

The group— Blair, Calli, Zee, Roman, Taryn, Quinn— huddle, still shaken from the stream. Phones in hand. Tension rising.

ROMAN
Okay. So, what the hell was that?

TARYN
Pathetic… Bitch went all desperate since hanging with those losers.

QUINN
You don't think that was real?

CALLI
Please. If any of this shit was real, the app would've been pulled already.

TARYN
Ah, cops can't stop you from live streaming. It's a basic human right. Freedom of speech, or some shit.

For once— Blair half agrees.

BLAIR
People streamed murders on Facebook. That was never shut down…

TARYN
Ew— who the fuck still uses Facebook?

Blair's too on edge for Taryn's usual shit— she snaps.

BLAIR
Oh my god. You completely missed the *fucking* point— again.

TARYN
Oh, no. Did I ruin your deep, edgy monologue moment?

The air thickens. Calli and Zee exchange a nervous glance.

BLAIR
You gaslighting fucking bitch.

BOOM! The tension detonates. Taryn's eyes flash.

TARYN
I am so over your trauma-baiting bullshit. We get it— you've got layers.

Taryn steps in. Blair flinches but stands her ground.

TARYN (CONT'D)
But you *chose* to be here, Blair. You *chose* to be there *that* night. You *always choose to keep* showing up.

BLAIR
You are *un-fucking-believable.*

TARYN
No, babe— I'm just the one saying what you're too scared to admit.

Quinn's eyes dart. Zee steps in.

ZEE
(to Taryn)
Bitch, do you ever hit pause, or is chaos your cardio?

TARYN
Oh, spare me, *Temu RuPaul*. We all have baggage— I just don't wear mine like a fucking crown.

Blair takes a step forward. Voice trembling with rage.

BLAIR
You don't *have* baggage, Taryn. *You are* the baggage.

That stings. Taryn falters, then— regathers. Smirking.

TARYN
Well at least I know who the fuck I am. You're just a fragile, hollow little mess that likes feeling broken because it's all you've got.

That one cuts Blair, deep. Calli clocks it. She steps in.

CALLI
Gurl. You need to step the fuck off.

Taryn turns— mock innocence on full display.

TARYN
Or what? You gonna go full *Eastside Barbie* on me?

Zee and Calli gasp— *oh, no she didn't.*

ROMAN
Taryn. Enough!

Taryn glares at him. Venom in her eyes.

TARYN
Fuck you, Roman!
(gasps)
Oh wait— I already did.

SLAP! Blair's hand cracks across Taryn's face. Taryn stumbles back. Clutching her cheek— then grins.

TARYN (CONT'D)
Guess Gemma was right.
(beat)
You *are* pathetic. Poor girl slit her own throat just to get away from you.

BOOM! Blair explodes. Screaming. Unhinged. She lunges— Zee and Roman catch her mid-flight. Holding her back.

TARYN (CONT'D)
And… *"Tragic Girl"* strikes again.
(beat)
You should really start charging for these performances.

She saunters off— grinning. Victory in her strut.

QUINN
Man. Y'all are wound *tight* as fuck.

Zee sighs, rubbing his temples.

ZEE
Honestly? That should've happened years ago.

INT. ORPHANAGE — ATTIC - NIGHT

Wind howls through cracked panes. Dust floats like ghosts in the moonlight.

Alfie creeps forward. Slowly. Flashlight slicing the dark. Eyes scanning the walls.

— Crayon drawings: stick figures bleeding, a looming shadow with an axe. A mask.

— Newspapers clippings. Yellowed with time:

- *CHRISTIAN CROWE: EVIL INCARNATE OR SCAPEGOAT?*
- *BLOOD, ORPHANS, AND AN AXE.*
- *THE BOY WHO LIVED… TO KILL: THE CHRISTIAN CROWE STORY.*
- *HE'S STILL HERE: CONSPIRATORS SAY CROWE NEVER DIED.*
- *THE BOOGEYMAN OF WILLOW'S CREEK.*

Alfie scoffs— bitterness buried in the sound.

ALFIE
The Boogeyman of Willow's Creek…
Jesus Christ.

He touches a wall— photos pinned like sacrament.

— Young Astrid with her friend. Matching "BFF" bracelets.

— Blair and Gemma. In Oak Haven. Blair wearing her "Blair" bracelet.

He unpins them. Stares. Then— his expression darkens. Realization dawning.

CREAK! Behind him. But, he doesn't turn. He doesn't need to.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
You used to hate this place. Said it smelled like cheap detergent and piss.

Alfie subtly slides the photos out the attic window. He turns.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
I half expect Sister Mary to pop out and slap the cigarette outta your mouth.

Silence.Then— from the dark— Christian Crowe emerges. Masked. Axe low— a ghost in flesh. Alfie doesn't flinch.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
It's been a long time, Christian.

EXT. PARTY MANSION — OUTSIDE BAR - NIGHT

Blair downs a shot. Calli watches, wary.

CALLI
You okay, B?

She slams the glass. Feeling the burn.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Who was Taryn talking about? Gemma?

Blair doesn't answer. She slams another shot. Zee scrolls *Snared*.

ZEE
What the fu— Roxy's accounts gone.

ROMAN
Gone how?

ZEE
Like… gone. Wiped. No posts. No bio. No links… It's like they Thanos-snapped her entire existence.

CALLI
It's a hype-bait PR stunt. Who cares?

ZEE
Nah. Roxy don't ghost mid-stream. Not with that many thirsty bitches watchin'.

Blair rolls her eyes— sardonic. She downs another shot.

BLAIR
Maybe she finally grew a conscience.

Calli snorts.

CALLI
Yeah, and Zee just turned straight.

Zee shrugs.

ZEE
Hell no. Not even for Florence Pugh.

Laughter. Then— Quinn's playful edge drops. He leans. Calm. Icy. Measured.

QUINN
It’s a classic misdirection.
Government does it all the time.

CALLI
Oh this’ll be good.

QUINN
I'm serious. Crisis management 101.
Shit never gets resolved. It just
gets redirected.

They glance at each other— a flicker of curiosity. He leans into it.

QUINN (CONT’D)
Epstein gets arrested. A month later—
Boom— dead in a high-security prison.
(beat)
Too many eyes. Too many names on the
list. Too much money to lose— so—

ROMAN
—They redirect our focus.

Quinn smirks.

QUINN
BINGO! Enter COVID. Within three
months the "mystery virus" turns into
a fucking global pandemic.

Zee exhales sharply. Calli rolls her eyes. Orders a double.

QUINN (CONT’D)
By the time Ghislaine’s arrested,
nobody gives a fuck about pedo
billionaires and kiddie-fiddler
islands.
(beat)
They're too busy side-eyeing anyone
who sneezes within six feet and
hoarding Charmin Ultra Soft like the
apocalypse only affects their fucking
assholes.

A heavy silence. No one wants to admit, but— he’s got a point.

QUINN (CONT'D)
And just like that — Mass abuse becomes another meme… a fucking punchline.

They shift uncomfortably. Zee clocks the tension. He deflects.

ZEE
Okay, thank you Alex Jones—

But, Blair's locked in.

BLAIR
What's your point?

Quinn leans forward. Cool. Cold.

QUINN
If that was real… they'll erase it. Classic bait and switch. Distract. Reset the narrative. Make it look like everything's fine— while behind the scenes, they're scrambling.
(beat)
Trying to figure out if a murder just streamed on their app IRL.

A chill settles. Silence. Zee laughs.

ZEE
Oh, my cousin Marcus is gonna love you.

Then— Sirens blast from the speakers. Sharp. Piercing. They flinch. Then— an eerie female voice from the speakers:

SNARED VOICE (V.O.)
Attention Streamers. Effective immediately under section 4A of The Tier Integrity Protocol, all Snares are suspended until further notice.

The party halts. Confusion ripples.

SNARED VOICE (V.O)
A mandatory IMMUNITY PERIOD is now active. Any streamer found violating their immunity— by initiating, provoking, engaging, promoting, or interacting with any Snares— will trigger the AUTO-BAN feature.

Murmurs grow louder. People checking phones.

SNARED VOICE (V.O.)
This includes— financial termination, content erasure, and permanent blacklisting.
(beat)
Take this time to celebrate… You've earned it.

The audio cuts out. All eyes snap to Quinn. He sips. Unbothered.

CALLI
Wait— didn’t Marcus and Roxy stream some bullshit ghost-hunting snare last night?

Everyone looks at her. Zee’s eyes widen— it clicks.

ZEE
Shit— yeah. Willow's Creek Orphanage.

CALLI
Who’s up for a little road trip?
(beat)
Prove her dumb ass is fine and kill this immunity period.

Blair hesitates, chewing her lip.

BLAIR
We don't know if it's real.

CALLI
That's the point, B.
(beat)
You want answers? Let's fucking get 'em.

QUINN
I'm in. Take my van. If they’re fine, we’re back for last call.

They head off, but— Blair lingers.

She looks toward the mansion— partying. Dancing. Grinding. Clueless. Then— her gaze shifts to the woods— lightning forks the sky— a storm is brewing.

She exhales. Swallows hard. And follows them.

EXT. PARTY MANSION — WOODS - NIGHT

Taryn treks through the dark. Her phone flashlight flares against the branches and shadows.

TARYN
(shouting)
Sasha!?… Brock!?

No response. She huffs, thumbs out a message:

@BRATTY.X.BUNNY: WHERE ARE YOU, SKANK? YOU JUST MISSED ANOTHER TRAGIC GIRL MELTDOWN. ALSO… WTF IS ROXY’S STREAM?

Send. No reply.

She stops. Listens. It’s quiet— the wrong kind of quiet. Even the usual hum of insects is gone. She glances around.

TARYN (CONT'D)
Okay— seriously. If you're trying to scare me, I will end you—

SQUELCH! Her heel slips. She crashes to her knees— hands plunging into thick, warm slop.

She lifts her palms. Mud— streaked with deep red blood.

She swings her flashlight onto— *Sasha.* Facedown. Motionless.

Taryn scrambles closer. Panicked. She rolls her over— two gaping black sockets where her eyes used to be.

She recoils, gagging. Turns— tries to run to run— trips. Face-first into the mud.

Her phone's beam catches— *Brock.* Pinned to a tree. Limbs stretched wide. Arms crucified. Jaw ripped open.

Taryn convulses. A strangled, soundless scream. She scrambles to her feet and bolts.

INT. POLICE CRUISER - NIGHT

The storm growls overhead. Lightning veins the sky. The radio crackles with static whispers.

Rhea grips the wheel— white-knuckled. Frank scrolls silently beside her.

RHEA
She looked terrified, Frank.

Frank scoffs. Eyes still on his phone.

FRANK
Knowing her, she probably offered a collab for her life.

RHEA
Jesus. She's still a *fucking* person.

Frank stops scrolling. Turns the phone toward her— Roxy's profile is wiped clean.

FRANK
Apparently… not anymore.

Rhea glances from the road to the screen— then—

BAM! Headlights. Blinding.

She slams the brakes. Tires screech. The cruiser fishtails.

Quinn's van roars past. Missing them by inches.

FRANK (CONT'D)
You good?

Rhea exhales— shaky. Nods.

RHEA
Yeah.

But her voice says otherwise.

INT. ORPHANAGE — ATTIC - NIGHT

Alfie stands firm. Staring down the monster he once knew.

ALFIE
You were just a kid when I found you.
Brought you here.

Alfie pulls out a flask. Takes a swig. Offers it to Crowe. He doesn't react. Doesn't shift. Just breathes.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
Used to sneak onto the roof after
lights out… Watch the stars.

Crowe tilts his head slightly. Animal-like.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
Then they took that from you. That
innocence.

Alfie steps closer. Careful. Heavy with guilt.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
The things they did… and made *you* do.

His eyes plead. Searching for something behind that mask.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
I thought I could help you. Control
the fire that fueled your rage.
(beat)
But I was wrong.

A pause. Heavy. Honest. He takes another long swig.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
No one controls you.

Crowe lowers his head slightly. It's not rage. Not hatred… it's shame. A hollow absence of humanity.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
Is that why you wear it? The mask?
(beat)
To hide what you've become?

Silence. Wind shrieks. Alfie's voice softens.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
You never had to hide from me. So why
start now?

Then— Crowe moves. He lifts the mask.

Alfie doesn't flinch. He stares into a face seared by trauma— a boyhood carved away. Twisted into myth. Forged into— *"The Boogeyman of Willow's Creek."*

ALFIE (CONT'D)
I'm sorry I failed you, son.
(beat)
But I can't let you keep hurting people.

A breath. A flicker of shared history— shattered.

Alfie draws fast— But Crowe's faster. A blade. A struggle.

BANG!

INT. QUINN'S VAN - NIGHT

The van creeps down the road. Headlights slice through mist.

INSIDE

A disaster zone— crushed energy drinks. Fast food wrappers. A graveyard of questionable life choices.

Quinn drives. Calli rides shotgun. Blair, Zee, and Roman crowd the back.

The van rolls to a stop— just short of the Orphanage. Quinn kills the engine. They sit. Stare. Silent.

ZEE
I'm officially filing this under *Worst Fucking Ideas Ever.*

Calli turns. Her mock sympathy dialed to ten.

CALLI
Aw. You scared, Sweetpea?

ZEE
No. I'm fucking smart. If it's PR— there's no one to save.

Blair's eyes stay locked on the Orphanage.

BLAIR
And if it's not?

Zee pauses. For once— no snark.

ZEE
Then she's already dead

CRACK! Lightning cleaves the sky. Rain pours. They all feel the ominous timing— but no one mentions it.

CALLI
Okay. So let's say this is real.
What's the plan?
(beat)
We just bust in Scooby-Doo style and
hope for a villain monologue?

No one laughs. No one speaks. No one moves. Then—

ROMAN
I'll go.

He slides the door open. Blair grabs his wrist— gentle. Firm.

Their eyes lock. A flicker of something old. Something real.

BLAIR
No. We all go. Or no one does.

Roman holds her gaze a second longer. Then— he smirks.

ROMAN
Well, I'm not sitting here all night
smelling Quinn's sweaty gym bag, so…

He hops out. Blair, Zee and Calli follow.

ZEE
Y'all have serious fucking issues.

Quinn lingers— sniffing the air. Genuinely puzzled.

QUINN
That's not sweat, dude.
(muttered)
It's *pheromones…*

They slide the van door shut.

INT. ORPHANAGE — ATTIC - NIGHT

Crowe stands. Wounded— but unfazed. Blood seeps from the fresh bullet wound in his shoulder.

Alfie kneels in a growing pool of his own blood. Hands trembling. Clutching the gaping wound in his stomach.

ALFIE
All these years, I wondered how you
survived.

He coughs blood. Laughs bitterly.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
Drowned. Burned. Buried alive.
(beat)
Hell, I even put five rounds in your
chest that night.

He looks up. No fear. Just regret— clarity.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
But now… looking into your eyes…
(beat)
I see the truth.

Crowe raises his head. Mechanical. Curious.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
You're not him anymore.

Crowe slides the mask back on. Alfie exhales, broken.

ALFIE (CONT'D)
You're something else.

THUNK! The axe falls. Fast. Clean. Merciless.

Alfie's head hits the floor. Blood seeps into the cracks.

INT. POLICE CRUISER - NIGHT

The cruiser idles off-road. Mansion lights in the distance.

Wipers whisper across glass. Frank refreshes his phone. Nothing.

RHEA
So… why'd the Bureau cut you loose?

Frank doesn't look up. Doesn't answer. But, she waits. Long enough for it to sting.

FRANK
You know what a deepfake is?

RHEA
Like the video of Kanye saying he liked Hitler?

Frank smirks.

FRANK
Nah. That shit was real.
(beat)
But imagine a video of you confessing to a murder— it's so real, even you start to wonder if you did it.

Rhea leans in, intrigued.

RHEA
You were making deepfakes?

FRANK
Fuck no. There was this hacker kid. Genius little shit. Not that I'd tell him that.
(beat)
(MORE)

FRANK (CONT'D)
I busted him blackmailing people with deepfakes— confessing to murder, rape, pedophilia— fucking heinous shit.
(beat)
Only way out? Pay him in Crypto.

RHEA
Jesus. Would've got a stretch.

FRANK
Should've. Only thing was— people he went after— Judges. Officials. Hollywood Producers— were all guilty.

RHEA
He have receipts?

FRANK
Everything. Texts. Emails. Photos— none of it fucking admissible.

She grins, dark.

RHEA
So he figures— if the truth won't stick… I'll build a better lie.

Frank nods.

FRANK
So, I cut him a deal. Told him—

THUMP! A bloody hand slams against Rhea's window. They both flinch— whip around.

Taryn— caked in mud and blood. Eyes wide. Panic incarnate.

Their doors fly open.

ON THE STREET

Taryn collapses. Rhea catches her— barely.

TARYN
(whispering)
They're dead.

Silence. Then— Frank's phone buzzes.

— UNKNOWN NUMBER: WE'RE AT THE ORPHANAGE IN WILLOW'S CREEK. DUDE, WTF HAVE YOU GOTTEN ME INTO?

FRANK
Fuck. It's happening.

They throw Taryn into the cruiser. Slam the doors. Peel out into the storm.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

The storm rages. The group huddles beneath the rotting awning. Soaked. Shivering.

BLAIR
(sarcastic)
This doesn't look haunted at all.

QUINN
Yeah— haunted by the spirit of asbestos.

Calli rattles the rusted door handle. Locked.

BLAIR
Maybe we try calling Roxy again. Or Marcus.

ZEE
Bitch, we tried that a dozen times. You got better odds of FaceTiming Vecna in the Upside Down.

Roman scans the crumbling façade. His eyes lock on the attic window— slightly ajar.

ROMAN
That's open.

Zee follows his gaze. Squinting.

ZEE
Cool. I'll just grab the ladder outta my bra.

Quinn eyes a rusted drainpipe.

QUINN
We could climb.

Zee stares at him. Disbelief.

ZEE
Absolutely the fuck not.
(beat)
What about me says I cosplay as Spider-Gwen?

Calli groans.

CALLI
Jesus Christ. Enough with the comedic relief.

Zee flips her off.

ZEE
It's a coping mechanism, bitch.

Blair notices something glinting in the mud. She crouches— picks up a Polaroid.

ZEE (CONT'D)
You know what? Fuck this.

He cups his hands. Yells.

ZEE (CONT'D)
Marcus! Get your punk ass out here or I'm callin' Aunt Sue-Ann!

Silence.

ZEE (CONT'D)
Yeah, he ain't here. I vote we GTFO.

ROMAN
How can you be sure?

Zee looks at him. Dead serious.

ZEE
You ain't ever met Aunt Sue-Ann.

Blair looks at the Polaroid. She pales. The air shifts.

CALLI
What is it?

She holds it up— the photo of Blair and Gemma.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Wait… is that you?

Blair nods. Roman and Zee tense.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Let me guess. That's Gemma… the one Taryn mentioned?

Blair swallows hard. Another nod.

BLAIR
She was… a friend. Until—

Emotion chokes her.

ZEE
Until she went full Hannah Baker and live-streamed her own death.

Roman cuts in— voice sharp.

ROMAN
C'mon, Zee… It was more than that.
(beat)
We pushed her. We're the *reason* she did it.

Quinn groans, turns away.

QUINN
Look, I'm gonna let y'all work this shit out. I'll check round back, maybe there's a busted window or some shit.

Calli grabs his arm.

CALLI
Fuck that. I'm coming with.
(beat)
If it is some psycho from their past, I think I'll be safer with you.

They disappear into the dark.

ZEE
Cool. Great. Yeah… solid plan. Let's split up. That always ends well.

INT. POLICE CRUISER - NIGHT

Red-blue lights strobe across the wet asphalt. Wipers slash the windshield.

Rhea drives, steel-eyed. Frank scrolls the kill list.

Taryn trembles in the back seat. Muddy. Bloody. Drenched.

FRANK
Sasha Wright. Brock Turner.

Taryn nods— sobbing. Frank and Rhea exchange a grim look.

FRANK (CONT'D)
They're on the list.

TARYN
List? What fucking list?

Frank tosses it to her. She flips through. Breath caught.

TARYN (CONT'D)
We're all here— Me. Roman. Blair.

FRANK
And a couple hundred others.
(beat)
Most already dead.

Taryn stares— silent. Lost.

TARYN
I— I don't get it. Why would someone—

Rhea's voice slices through her confusion— ice-cold.

RHEA
Gemma Beckett wasn't just some introvert you humiliated for clout.

Taryn stiffens.

RHEA (CONT'D)
Her real name was Astrid Crowe.
(beat)
She was in witness protection— until your stupid ass dragged her back into the spotlight.

Her smug veneer shatters.

TARYN
W-We never meant for her to—

FRANK
Yeah, well. Little late for that.

She flips back through the file. Then— stops.

TARYN
Wait… Someone's missing.

A heavy silence. Frank and Rhea share a look. Tension. Dread.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

Blair, Roman, and Zee still under the awning— nerves frayed.

Roman scans the dark. Jaw tight. Blair clocks it.

BLAIR
What is it?

Roman contemplates for a sec.

ROMAN
Where'd she come from? Calli?

Zee rolls his eyes.

ZEE
Oh, you're clutching, Ro.

BLAIR
She's got nothing to do with this.
She wasn't even there that night.

ROMAN
You're right, she wasn't.

His eyes narrow, pressing harder.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
She just shows up one day— acting like your fucking savior.

BLAIR
It's not her fault you couldn't keep your dick out of my cousin.
(beat)
(MORE)

BLAIR (CONT'D)
She just helped clean up the wreckage.

Zee folds his arms.

ZEE
You wanna talk 'bout *"just showin' up."* What's with the fuckboy Quinn?

Blair frowns.

ZEE (CONT'D)
Playa rolls up like some budget Hemsworth, cracks a few memes, and now we're road-trippin' through murder county, separated and shit?

ROMAN
Or maybe it's both of 'em.

Blair stares at the Polaroid. Zee spots something sprawled on the back. He takes it. Flips it over— smudged handwriting:

— Astrid & Blair, 2020, Oak Haven. Together Forever.

ZEE
Who the fuck is Astrid?

Blair's face shifts. Realization hits.

BLAIR
I'm not who you think I am.
(beat)
Maybe this is what she—

BAM! Calli crashes out of the shadows. Bloodied. Gasping. Clutching her side.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Oh Shit—

Blair catches her as she collapses.

CALLI
It's Quinn… he attacked me.

They all freeze. Eyes snap to the woods. Silence. No Quinn.

ZEE
Can you run?

Calli winces. Shakes her head.

ROMAN
Then we leave her.

Blare looks up. Shocked. Confused.

ZEE
He's right, B. If fuckboy's gone full Patrick Bateman, we need to Usain Bolt the shit outta here.

Blair glares. Furious.

BLAIR
It's not a fucking option. Help me.

No one moves.

ROMAN
How do we know she's not part of it?

Calli lifts her shirt— revealing a stab wound.

CALLI
Because I'm *bleeding,* asshole!

BLAIR
You think she stabbed herself?

Zee shrugs. Deadpan.

ZEE
Bitch, you ever see *Scream*?

THUD! Something heavy crashes behind them. They whip around.

At their feet— *Alfie's severed head.* Mouth agape. Eyes wide.

Panic flares— Blair gasps. Zee stumbles back. Roman goes pale.

No words. No plan. Roman and Zee grab Calli— they vanish into the woods.

INT. POLICE CRUISER - NIGHT

The cruiser barrels through the rain-slicked turns. Rhea lowers her phone. Tense.

RHEA
Alfie's not picking up.

Frank scans the kill list.

FRANK
Good. He's safer out of this.

In the back, Taryn fidgets. Wrings her hands. Frank shuts the file. Glances at Rhea.

FRANK (CONT'D)
She's right.

Rhea eyes Taryn in the mirror.

RHEA
You got a photo?

Taryn nods, fumbling through her phone with shaky fingers. She hands it to Frank.

He scrolls— party shots. Flash-lit chaos. Drinking. Drugs. Red cups. Blurry smiles. Then—

CLICK! A group shot freezes. Mid-laugh. Mid-life.

Frank tenses. Something hits. Rhea catches it.

RHEA (CONT'D)
What is it?

No answer. He rifles through the case file. Frantic.

EXT. WOODS - NIGHT

Rain slices. Trees blur past. Blair, Zee, Calli, and Roman tear through the underbrush— mud flying. Branches slashing.

Roman risks a glance back— his eyes widen in terror.

ROMAN
FUCKING RUN!

Crowe barrels after them. Axe raised. Inhuman. Unstoppable.

Zee's foot catches a mud slicked rock—

CRASH! He hits the deck, hard. Dazed. Winded.

Blair skids to a stop. Hauls him up. But— Crowe's closing in fast, when—

WHACK! Zee kicks out, hard. Collecting Crowe's legs.

Crowe stumbles. The axe slips from his grip. He collapses— head cracking against a rock. He's out— cold. Motionless.

A split-second of breathing room. But, Calli drops to the ground— clutching her wound. Groaning.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
(to Blair)
I got Zee— help her!

Blair bolts to Calli. Roman hauls Zee up. Staggering. Then—

WHAM! Crowe's hand lashes out— clamping around Roman's ankle.

Roman locks eyes with Zee— a silent, final choice.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
GO!

Zee runs. Toward Blair and Calli. Vanishing into the trees.

Crowe pulls Roman down. They struggle then— Roman stops.

Crowe rises— axe in hand. Roman looks him dead in the eye. Acceptance.

ROMAN (CONT'D)
If this makes it right…
(beat)
Then end it.

CRACK! The axe splits his chest. Silence.

He yanks the blade free. Turns. Follows the blood deeper into the woods.

INT. POLICE CRUISER - NIGHT

Frank flicks through case files. Mugshots. Statements. Autopsies. Then— he stops. Eyes wide. Breath gone. He pulls out an old Polaroid—

— Young Astrid with her friend. Matching "BFF" bracelets.

Then— he sees it. A faint birthmark under the other girl's bracelet. Jagged. Subtle. Almost… avian-like.

He grabs Taryn's phone. Zooms in on the party pic— Calli, mid-laugh. There— on her wrist— the same jagged birthmark.

FRANK
Oh Fuck…

Rhea snaps to him.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Raven's… Crowe's.
(beat)
Same fucking family.

He holds up both photos.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Caroline Williams.

Rhea exhales. Horror settling in.

RHEA
Her foster sister.

The truth lands— hard. Then—

THUMP! Quinn— blood-soaked, staggering— stumbles into the headlights.

Rhea jerks the wheel—

WHACK! They clip him. The cruiser hydroplanes—

OFF THE ROAD—

BAM! They slam into a tree. Metal crunches. Glass explodes. Airbags erupt. Then— the deafening pitch of silence.

EXT. WOODS — DEEPER IN - NIGHT

Blair and Calli sprint. Gasping. Calli stumbles. Collapses against a gnarled tree.

CALLI
I can't… I'm slowing you down.

CRASH! Zee bursts through the foliage. Wild-eyed.

BLAIR
Where's Roman?

He shakes his head. Breathless.

ZEE
It ain't just Quinn… there's some big asshole in a mask.

CALLI
What?

ZEE
Motherfucker looks like Dwayne Johnson… on more steroids.

Blair and Zee scan the dark. No sign of Crowe.

CALLI
So this is all happening because you killed Astrid?

Blair tenses— eyes narrowing.

BLAIR
We didn't kill anyone. She—

Everything freezes. Zee and Blair lock eyes, shocked— *did she just say… Astrid?*

CALLI
One person's truth is another person's lie, right?

The phrase hits like a bullet. They spin—

SHUNK! A blade punches through Zee's torso. He gasps.

Calli leans in— whispering like poisoned honey.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Oh Zee. You were fun… but fucking predictable.

Zee grits his teeth. Bleeding out. But, he grins—

ZEE
At least I broke the stereotype.

He drops. Calli watches. Grinning darkly.

CALLI
That sucks. I actually kinda liked him… her… they…? Whatever the fuck the pronouns were.

Blair's paralyzed. Shock. Fear.

Behind her: a shadow rises. The mask. The axe. She turns—

CRACK! The axe handle slams into the side of her skull.

SMASH TO BLACK:

EXT. POLICE CRUISER - NIGHT

Steam hisses from the wreck. Rain slices through the shattered windshield.

INSIDE THE WRECK

Frank groans. Bleeding. Disoriented. Breath ragged.

Rhea wheezes— her leg twisted under the dash. She blinks— spots Taryn. Sprinting into the woods. Alone.

RHEA
Frank…

Frank jolts upright.

FRANK
Taryn!

She doesn't stop.

Frank kicks his door open. Stumbles out. Dizzy— but moving. He circles the wreck. Grabs Rhea, but— she pushes him back.

RHEA
Go! Get her— I'll call it in!

FRANK
Fuck her. I'm getting you out.

He grips the dashboard. Wrenches it back. Rhea screams— dragging her leg free. They collapse. Soaked. Breathless.

Then— her eyes narrow. A figure limping toward Quinn's van.

Frank draws his weapon.

EXT. QUINN'S VAN - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Frank moves. Silent. Gun raised. He grips the handle— slides the door open.

INSIDE

Quinn. Crouched. Drenched in blood. He jolts— locks eyes with Frank's gun.

For a second— pure panic. Then— irritation.

QUINN
I'm changing your name in my phone to *"Don't Fucking Answer."*

Frank exhales. Lowers the gun.

INT. KILL ROOM - NIGHT

A flickering bulb buzzes. The room stinks of rust, sweat, and mildew.

Blair slumps against a crumbling wall— blood crusted on her forehead. Her wrists and ankles are lashed to a rusted water pipe. Skin raw. Rope biting deep.

Across the room— Calli adjusts her phone on a tripod. Frames the shot. Knife in hand.

She glances at Blair. Stirring.

CALLI
Holy shit. I was starting to think you were dead.

Blair's eyes flutter. Groggy— then clarity hits. She thrashes.

BLAIR
Help! *HELP!*

Calli sighs. Drives the knife into the table.

CALLI
Oh, calm down, Drama Queen.

BLAIR
Fuck You!

Calli circles. Slow. Predatory.

CALLI
Y'know… I never thought I'd say this, but— Taryn was right.
(beat)
At least she owns being a cunt.
(beat)
You? You wear this holier-than-thou pseudo-virgin bullshit like a fucking halo. It's exhausting.

Blair glares up. Equal parts fear and fury.

BLAIR
You're insane.

Calli tilts her head. Mock-hurt. Clinical

CALLI
Insane? No, babe. That would suggest I have behavioral issues that prevent normal perception or social interaction… I don't.

She leans in close. Intimate. Icy.

CALLI (CONT'D)
I'm in complete control of my emotions.

She smiles. Sweet. Serene. Sociopathic.

CALLI (CONT'D)
I smile when I want…

Then— she lunges. Grabs Blair's throat.

CALLI (CONT'D)
…and I lose my fucking *shit* when I want.

Blair gasps— but keeps eye contact. Refusing to break.

Calli notices the *"BLAIR"* bracelet on her wrist. Her lip curls in disgust.

CALLI (CONT'D)
You don't deserve this.

She rips it off. Pockets it. Blair simmers— a contained rage.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Aww. Don't pout. Life's too short to bury your emotions.
(beat)
Say what you feel. Before it's too late.

Something shifts. The phrase *hits*. But, Blair doesn't flinch.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Really? Still nothing?
(beat)
No shocked gasp? No dramatic…
(mocking)
"Oh my god, you're Astrid's sister."

She scoffs, shaking her head.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Y'know what? That's on me. I built this up in my head.
(beat)
A whole sobbing *"why are you doing this"* meltdown.
(beat)
I had this killer monologue prepped. Revenge. Trauma. Betrayal. All the crowd-pleasers. Then BAM—

She slams her hand on the wall— Blair flinches.

CALLI (CONT'D)
You break free— I drop some badass one-liner that goes viral. Maybe print it on a t-shirt. Monetize it.

She sighs. Deflated.

CALLI (CONT'D)
But nope. You just sit there. Like a fucking paperweight.

Blair meets her gaze. Calm. Measured.

BLAIR
Yeah. Almost as pathetic as your little revenge arc.

Calli's grin twitches. Her eyes narrow. Blair notices.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Foster sister? Really? You weren't even blood.

CALLI
Blood makes you related… Loyalty makes you family.

BLAIR
Right. Guess that's why she pitied you so much.

That cuts deep— Calli picks up the knife.

EXT. QUINN'S VAN - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

A laptop glows. Code streams across the screen. Quinn types— hypnotic. Surgical.

Frank leans against the van wall. A rag to his head. Watching.

FRANK
I'm starting to think the FBI wanted your ass for more than just a deepfake side hustle.

Quinn smirks. Rhea climbs in. Banged up. Bruised. Limping.

RHEA
Sherriff's are on the way.

Frank nods. Rhea looks at Quinn, surprised.

RHEA (CONT'D)
This is your deepfake kid?

Quinn pivots to meet her gaze.

QUINN
Don't let the boyish charm and devastating bone structure fool you, Kemo Sabe.
(beat)
I ain't some Red Bull-chugging script kiddie who binged *Mr. Robot* and thinks copy-pasting Python from GitHub makes him a cyberpunk.

Blank stares. He cracks his knuckles.

QUINN (CONT'D)
I'm like a fucking Jedi… and you're in my world now, Padawan.

Rhea arches a brow. Frank almost smiles.

FRANK
Then why aren't we kicking down the front door?

QUINN
Because it's not 1999, Agent Mulder.
(beat)
It ain't about the size of your Sabre. It's about the size of your… bandwidth. Evolution, baby.

Lines of code rip down the screen.

RHEA
What are we looking at?

QUINN
Snared was never designed to be some platform for wannabe Knoxville's.
(beat)
It was a test bed. A surveillance op called *The Pantheon Program.*
(beat)
Kinda like XKEYSCORE on meth.

Rhea squints.

RHEA
The fuck is that?

FRANK
Geo-tracking. Keylogging. Audio scrapes. Live cam access.
(beat)
Stalkerware. Tracks everyone, everywhere.

Quinn nods. Smiles. Impressed.

QUINN
After Snowden, the Feds panicked. Killed the program and quietly auctioned it off to some Silicon Valley tech-bro with a man-bun.
(MORE)

QUINN (CONT'D)
(beat)
Douchebag slaps on a colorful logo. Turns it as a digital *Squid Game* for dopamine junkies, but— forgets to deadbolt the back fucking door.

Frank stares him down.

FRANK
You said you *closed* it.

Quinn raises his hands, faux-defensive.

QUINN
I said I was *going to* close it.
(beat)
Then I met this barista with Daddy issues and a fucking Chihuahua on coke— I kinda got distracted—

FRANK
So you still have access?

Quinn leans back, smug.

QUINN
Every DM. Every stream. Every dick pic from Malibu to Minsk.
(glancing at Rhea)
Not that I look at that shit. Obviously.

Rhea scoffs. Rolls her eyes. Frank cuts in, all business.

FRANK
So what's the play?

QUINN
Snared already hit the panic button when they triggered an auto-ban.

Frank and Rhea share a look— underwhelmed.

RHEA
That's it? You're getting people banned?

Quinn grins.

QUINN
Nah. We're droppin' a fucking MOAB…

His eyes locked on the screen. Fingers flying.

QUINN (CONT'D)
…the Mother Of All… Backdoors.

INT. KILL ROOM - NIGHT

Blair's chest heaves. Fast. Her wrists— red, raw, trembling.

BLAIR
So you're The Raven?

Calli mock-curtsies.

BLAIR (CONT'D)
Bullshit. I got messages while you were right in front of me.

CALLI
It's called post-scheduling, dumbass.
(beat)
Jesus. You really are as stupid as you look.

BANG! The door slams open.

Crowe steps in. Axe strapped across his back. A heavy canvas sack slung over his shoulder.

THUD! He drops it. Something squirms inside. A terrified whimper. He yanks it open—

Taryn spills out. Gagged. Bloodied. Wide-eyed.

BLAIR
TARYN!?

Blair thrashes. Screaming.

CALLI
Don't waste tears on her. She's the reason this whole thing worked.

She paces. Twirling the blade.

CALLI (CONT'D)
I spun a little trauma tale to some limp-dick with a man-bun and a savior complex.
(beat)
A few fake orgasms later and boom— Architect access. All to keep his marriage from blowing up the way I blew him.

She kneels beside Taryn— almost gentle.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Sent this little nympho slut the Snare to ride Roman. Swooped in, with tissues and a sympathetic ear and, boom— *BFF mode: Activated.*

She turns to Blair— grinning.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Double dosing your happy pills? That was all you. So desperate to keep the demons quiet— you pop that shit like Tic Tacs.

Taryn locks eyes with Blair. Desperate. Begging.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Trust someone long enough… you only see what you want to see.
(beat)
Astrid learned that the hard way.

A flicker in Calli— rage barely caged. She pivots— walks to the knife.

Blair pulls hard on the rope. She winces — a sharp sting. Her eyes flick down— a jagged, rusted pipe bracket.

Her mind fires. A weapon? A chance? She exhales. Plays along.

INT. QUINN'S VAN - NIGHT

Rain drums the roof. Tension tight. Quinn's fingers hover over the keyboard.

FRANK
What the hell do you mean *"scorched earth?"*

QUINN
We're not just shadow-banning, dude. This is burn-it-to-the-ground type shit.

Rhea and Frank exchange a wary look.

QUINN (CONT'D)
One click. One like. One swipe— boom. Digital fucking leprosy.
(beat)
No cache. No backups. No rebuilds.
(beat)
Scorched. Fucking. Earth.

A grim silence. Rhea looks at Frank.

RHEA
And you're okay with that?

FRANK
They watched people die. Cheered. Called it content.
(beat)
You don't get to spectate murder and walk away clean.

Rhea looks toward the orphanage. Dark. Monolithic. Silent. Still not sure where her moral line ends.

RHEA
As long as it's for the right reasons, huh?

Quinn smiles faintly.

QUINN
But first…

CLICK! The screen flickers. A live feed— *The Kill Room.*

QUINN (CONT'D)
Let's give this bitch her fifteen minutes.

INT. KILL ROOM - NIGHT

Calli's phone lights up. Blair's eyes snap to it— glowing with the live stream. Her pulse spikes. Hope flickers.

Calli kneels by Taryn— knife in hand. Calm. Taunting.

CALLI
People really underestimate how exhausting it is being a killer.

She leans in— stroking a blood-matted curl from her cheek.

CALLI (CONT'D)
All the screaming. Crying. Begging. Like their lives are the only ones that matter.

Taryn whimpers, flinching. Calli rolls her eyes.

CALLI (CONT'D)
You post thirst traps like you're hot shit… but goddamn— you've got an ugly cry face.

Blair grinds her wrists against the jagged pipe bracket. It cuts deep. Blood beads. Fibers fray.

Calli rips Taryn's gag.

TARYN
Please… I-I'm sorry.

Calli tilts her head. Pouts. Wipes a tear from Taryn's cheek.

CALLI
Oh, babe. You're not sorry…

She lifts Taryn's chin. They lock eyes.

CALLI (CONT'D)
You're just scared.

SLASH! One clean motion.

Taryn's throat opens. Arterial spray. Her body spasms. Eyes lock with Blair's, then— nothing.

Blair shakes. Chokes down a scream. Silent. Rage swelling. Tears threatening— but she doesn't break— *she won't.*

INT. QUINN'S VAN - NIGHT

The stream plays— Taryn’s execution. Blair’s trembling restraint. Rhea recoils— hand over mouth.

RHEA
Jesus Christ…

Frank watches. Jaw tight. Rage simmering.

FRANK
I thought you had control.

QUINN
Yeah… of the fucking app.
(beat)
Not the knife-happy sociopath.

Rhea grabs the door— mid-exit.

RHEA
I need to bring her in.

Her leg gives. She stumbles— Frank catches her.

FRANK
You’re not going anywhere on that.

RHEA
Sheriff’s are still thirty minutes out. We can’t wait.

FRANK
Then I’ll go.

RHEA
You’re not a cop anymore, Frank.

He meets her gaze. Grounded. Certain.

FRANK
Exactly… I don’t have to play by the rules.

RHEA
And Crowe?

Frank shrugs. Just enough confidence to worry them both.

FRANK
We’re overdue for a chat anyway.

Quinn looks up. No smirk. Just fear.

QUINN
Dude, seriously? You go out there, he’ll turn you into fucking mulch.

He winces— pain flaring. Blood leaks through his shirt.

RHEA
You're bleeding through.

He shakes it off. Typing faster, desperate.

QUINN
I'm fine… Just need sixty seconds.
I'll sever the fucking head off this
beast for good.

Frank grabs a flashlight.

FRANK
That's great for nuking the app…
(beat)
But unless you've got malware for a
seven-foot axe-wielding nightmare…

He checks his sidearm.

FRANK (CONT'D)
…I'm going in.

He slides the van door shut behind him.

INT. KILL ROOM - NIGHT

Calli kneels beside Taryn's corpse.

CALLI
People act like killing someone is
this big, life-altering moment.

She shoves Taryn's head aside— disgusted.

CALLI (CONT'D)
It's really not.

Calli wipes Taryn's blood from the blade. Cool. Unbothered. She rises. Eyes Crowe— watching. Unmoving.

CALLI (CONT'D)
You need an invitation, Big Guy?
(beat)
Get rid of the body.

A beat, then— Crowe obeys. Axe in one hand. Taryn over his shoulder. We walks out.

Blair works the ropes. Bleeding. Frantic. Focused.

Calli exhales. Casual. Centered in the carnage.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Well… if nothing else, that was
fucking cathartic.

She turns to Blair— unaware of the live-stream.

BLAIR
What happens after you kill me?

CALLI
I feel lighter. Content.

BLAIR
Bullshit. You'll realize you've got no purpose.
(beat)
No Astrid. No revenge. No fake friends to gaslight… Just you. Pathetic, alone and empty.

Calli twitches. Smiles through it.

CALLI
There it is. That venomous tongue.
(beat)
Even when you played *Saint Blair*, I always smelled the rot underneath.

BLAIR
Nah. That's just the stench of all your bullshit.

Calli laughs.

CALLI
That's cute. But playtime's over Blair-Bear.

She stalks toward Blair— blade in hand. Blair tries baiting even further.

BLAIR
No one's gonna believe I did this.

THUNK! Calli buries the knife into the ledge— inches from Blair's head.

CALLI
Sure they will. Tragic girl. PTSD. Prozac. Tremors. Shattered psyche— check, check, check. You were a ticking time bomb, B…
(beat)
You just finally snaped.

BLAIR
Yeah? Then why'd I spare you?

CALLI
Love. I'll say you were obsessed— a real stage five clinger.

She steps back— voice cracking, eyes watering.

CALLI (CONT'D)
I saw the signs. I tried to help. I thought… maybe some time away with friends would—

She breaks. Face in her hands. Sobbing. Shaking. Crying. A perfect mess.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Oh my god. It's my fault she did this.

Then— she drops the act. Snaps back— grinning.

CALLI (CONT'D)
No one'll press too hard. If they do? I'll say it's survivor's guilt… cue the waterworks. No one'll bat an eye.

BLAIR
You've got it all figured out, huh?

CALLI
Of course I do. I've lived in that cesspool long enough to know how it works.
(beat)
It's a fucking spectator sport. They gorge themselves on someone else's pain, call it activism— then beg for likes to soothe their fragile fucking egos.

Blair scoffs.

BLAIR
And you're better than them?

Calli smiles.

CALLI
Abso-fucking-lutely. These cancel-culture vultures don't give a fuck about truth or justice… They crave chaos. A villain to crucify so they can ignore their own fucked-up lives.

She leans over Blair. Eyes burning.

CALLI (CONT'D)
I can already hear their parasocial sob stories— *"OMG, I knew her in college… this could've been me."*

She sneers.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Then some knock-off Blair 2.0 will hijack my trauma, slap their face on some YouTube clickbait podcast, and sell merch with a fucking promo code.

Blair glares at her, nodding.

BLAIR
Congrats. I guess you got your monologue after all.

Calli smirks. Mockingly sweet.

CALLI
Now, it's time to give the audience what they came for, Blair-Bear.

Blair locks eyes with her. Steady.

BLAIR
Actually… I think *you* just did.

Calli frowns. Blair nods toward the phone.

Calli spins. Sees the screen. Her face. The blade. Blair. All of it. Streaming— *LIVE.*

Her face drains. She lunges for the phone.

SNARED LIVE pulses on screen. View count spikes: 398K… 1.7M… 2.1B. The countdown timer ticks: *00:10… 00:09… 00:08.*

EXT. PARTY MANSION — MAIN STAGE - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

Calli's blood-specked face fills the massive screen. Silence drops like a guillotine. Phones out. Mouths open. Horror.

Two INFLUENCERS— draped in glowsticks— stare at their screens. Shocked.

PARTY GIRL
Did… did you just like that?

PARTY GUY
(panicked)
No! No… I-I didn't do fucking shit.

DA-DING! — ACCOUNT BANNED.
DA-DING! — PROFILE REMOVED.
DA-DING! — VIOLATION LOGGED.

And then— pandemonium.

Screams. Alerts. Screens glitch. Feeds crash. Profiles vanish mid-scroll. Ego's crumble— *a digital wildfire.*

INT. QUINN'S VAN - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

Quinn watches as the digital dominoes fall. His head dips slightly. Eyes glassy. Breathing shallow.

DA-DING! DA-DING! DA-DING!

The screen floods with cascading alerts.

— PROFILES DEACTIVATED: 141K… 980K… 8.3M… 1.1B…

Rhea stares— stunned.

RHEA
You fucking did it.

Quinn jolts. Eyes wide. He forces a smile.

QUINN
Time for an encore.

He reaches for the keyboard— winces. Hands trembling. His shirt clings, dark with blood.

RHEA
Shit.

She lunges toward him— but he collapses.

INT. KILL ROOM - NIGHT (SAME TIME)

Blair tears at the rope. Adrenaline surging. Her wrists bleed but, she's almost through.

Calli stares into the camera. Frozen. Exposed.

The comment feed explodes:

— *@XXTRAUMATOKXX: WTF? THIS BITCH IS STREAMING?*
— *@CANCELS4KARMA: YOU'RE NUKED, DUMBASS.*
— *@CLIQUEBAIT: WAIT, IS THIS A HOAX OR REAL?*

Calli's thumb hovers— shaking— then—

GLITCH!

AUTO-BAN TRIGGERED. STREAM TERMINATED. ACCOUNT DEACTIVATED.

Her eyes snap wide.

CALLI
I'm gonna fucking kill you—

She spins—

SHANK! Blair drives the blade into her gut.

Calli gasps. Chokes. Blood bubbles from her lips.

Blair's eyes lock with hers.

BLAIR
You go live, or you don't go at all, bitch.

She rips the blade free. Calli drops the phone— face up— as she collapses. Then—

THUD! THUD! THUD! Heavy boots hammer the hallway.

BAM! The door blasts open. Crowe storms in— axe in hand. He scans. Blair— free. Then Calli— bleeding. Writhing.

Calli points. Gurgling.

CALLI
Kill her! *Fucking KILL HER!*

Crowe steps toward Blair. Axe raised. Then a voice stops him— Calli's voice.

He freezes. Looks down at Calli's phone on the floor. Her face fills the screen. Calm. Cruel. Cold.

CALLI (CONT'D)
(deepfake)
Christian Crowe is a fucking puppet. A weapon with legs. I wind him up, he swings the axe.

Crowe's breath slows. Calli's brow furrows.

CALLI (CONT'D)
What the fuck— that's not me.

Crowe stares at the screen. The deepfake continues.

CALLI (CONT'D)
(deepfake)
And Astrid? Please. She was a weak little bitch. Always was. She deserved to die.

Crowe trembles with rage. Calli's panic surges.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Christian. *That's not me,* okay. Why would I—

SMASH! He stomps the phone. Calli flinches.

CALLI (CONT'D)
(panicked)
It's AI, okay?! Some deepfake bullshit! It's not real!

He steps forward. She crawls. Blood smearing across the floor.

CALLI (CONT'D)
Christian. No. Please—
(softer)
I loved Astrid. I love you… You're the only family I have…

He kneels beside her. One hand cradles her head. The other covers her mouth. Her eyes plead with Crowe.

CALLI (CONT'D)
(muffled)
Please… Dad!… Please don't—

SNAP! A clean, brutal twist. Calli drops. Lifeless.

Crowe rises. Turns. Eyes locked on Blair— she bolts.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — FRONT DOOR - DAWN

Rain slows as Frank nears the orphanage. Flashlight in one hand. Gun in the other.

Then— he stops. A shape in the mud. The flashlight lands on— Alfie's severed head. Half-buried. Pale. Muddy.

Frank staggers. Drops to his knees above Alfie. His breathing sharpens— bloodshot eyes grow wild. Unhinged.

FRANK
CROWE!!

He surges to his feet— rage propelling him toward the door—

BAM! Blair bursts through. Crashing into him. They hit the ground, hard.

Frank sees her face. Bloodied. Scared. Alive. He pulls her up. They run.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — PADDOCK - DAWN (CONTINUOUS)

They sprint across the paddock. Quinn's van dead ahead. Then— Frank stops.

Blair whirls, panicked. He locks eyes with her. Calm. Steeled.

FRANK
Go.

BLAIR
What?!

FRANK
GO!

She runs. Frank turns back— toward the orphanage. Crowe stands in the doorway— axe across his chest.

Frank raises his pistol— *fifteen years of grief and guilt boiling behind his eyes.*

The world stills. The storm quiets. The wind dies. Then—

BANG! A shot to the shoulder. Crowe doesn't flinch.

BANG! BANG! Another two hits. Still nothing.

Then— Crowe charges.

BANG! BANG! BANG! —— HIT! HIT! HIT!

CLICK! Empty— *Dead Man's Click.*

Frank freezes up. Crowe's almost on him—

BANG! A final, clean shot.

Crowe stops— a perfect hole in the center of his mask. He drops.

Behind Frank— Rhea lowers her weapon. Limping forward.

Frank doesn't move. Locked in shock. Arm trembling.

Rhea places a hand on his gun. Guides it down. Gentle.

RHEA
(soft)
Hey. We got him.

Frank blinks. Reality rushes back. Breath returns.

She smiles. Brushes the side of his face.

RHEA (CONT'D)
We got him.

Sirens wail in the distance. The horizon glows pink and gold. A new day breaks.

EXT. PARTY MANSION — FRONT LAWN - MORNING (LATER)

The sun pierces the mist. Police tape flutters. Foil blankets. Survivors— some crying, some scrolling- all numb.

PARAMEDICS wheel out gurneys— Sasha. Brock. Lifeless. Bagged.

The biggest social flex of the year— now a war zone.

EXT. SALOON - MORNING (SAME TIME)

LOCALS sip coffee. Whisper. Smoke.

PARAMEDICS wheel out two more gurneys— Hayden. Elsie. Sheets over both.

The town watches. No panic. Just silence… and cigarettes.

EXT. ORPHANAGE — PADDOCK - MORNING (SAME TIME)

Blood. Mud. Bullet casings. More body bags. Cameras flash.

Blair, Rhea, and Frank— wrapped in foil blankets. Silent. Processing.

QUINN (O.S.)
Y'know your friend was kind of a bitch.

Blair turns. Quinn's on a gurney. Bandaged. Smirking.

She rushes him. Hugs tight. He winces, but doesn't stop her.

BLAIR
Yeah… yeah, she was.

They smile— battle-bonded.

Another gurney rolls past— Calli. Blair stops it.

She reaches into her pocket. Pulls out the beaded *"Blair"* bracelet. A beat. Then nods. They wheel Calli away.

QUINN
What's that?

BLAIR
A reminder.

QUINN
Oh, okay. You get a cute little bracelet and I get nearly hacked in half? That's fair.

She laughs— real, for once. Rhea and Frank approach.

QUINN (CONT'D)
Told you deepfakes would come in handy one day.
(beat)
This shit mean we're even now?

Frank smirks. They shake hands.

FRANK
For now.

They all watch Crowe's body bag hoisted into an ambulance. Then— an EMT moves to load Quinn into the same rig.

QUINN
Nope. No fucking way. I've seen enough horror movies. You think they're dead, then BAM— eyes shoot open and shit. Fuck that.

Fair point. The medic reroutes him. Blair follow. Shaking her head. Grinning through it.

Frank and Rhea watch Crowe's ambulance disappear into the morning mist.

RHEA
Maybe now they'll let me put on another badge.

She side-eyes Frank.

RHEA (CONT'D)
You interested?

FRANK
You want me to leave the city, come back to Willow's Creek, and work with you as my boss?

Rhea smirks— slow and loaded. Frank chuckles. Wraps an arm around her. She leans in.

FRANK (CONT'D)
I'll think about it.

For the first time in a long time, things feel… settled.

INT. AMBULANCE - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

The siren wails. Tires slice wet asphalt.

INSIDE

Two Gen Z medics— TYLER (22), driving, and THEO (22), in the back with Crowe.

Crowe lies strapped down. Motionless. Mask intact. Theo stares at Crowe, smirking.

THEO
Bro… we're gonna monetize the *shit* outta you.

TYLER
Can you imagine? *Snared 2.0.*

THEO
Two-Point—No. Fuck that. We go next level. Full immersive, *"Snared V.R."*
(mock-announcer)
'Can YOU survive The Willow's Creek Massacre?'

Tyler nods. Amped.

TYLER
Oh, that's straight Da Vinci, bro.

Theo leans in. Tapping the bullet fracture in Crowe's mask.

THEO
He ain't even that fuckin' scary.

CRACK! The mask cracks in two. Theo rips it off.

Crowe's face is scarred. Twisted. But… No blood. No bullet wound.

Theo's face drops.

THEO (CONT'D)
Oh, fuck—

CROWE'S EYES SNAP OPEN.

EXT. HIGHWAY - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

The rig swerves. Tires screech. It flips.

SMASH TO BLACK: